

9MB

RS-63

90 days of library 2nd floor  
without seeing much daylight.  
Make this count <3

pg 14 post mid

Progga Paromita

Nakshatra Roy

me and Pital-un-bhutta (sister) (sister the best)

an empty Tanager House. Make sure? (sister)



# BENGAL FROM THE 7TH CENTURY TO THE BATTLE OF PLASSEY

• Maurya Dynasty - (321 - 185 BCE)

- ↳ when King Ashoka ruled (3rd ruler of Mauryan Dynasty)
- ↳ greatest ruler of all time



• Gupta Empire - (319-467 AD)

[disintegrated during the 6th century]

major religion at that time was Buddhism

• King Shashanka (590-625 AD)



☉ Sanskrit speaking king

- ↳ divided the Gupta empire into Gaura and Vanga (origin of the word Bengal)
- ↳ from Gaura Dynasty (present day West Bengal + Bangladesh)
- ↳ creator of Bengali calendar
- ↳ follower of Shiva (upper class Hindu - Brahmin/Shastriya) (gave priority to other followers of Shiva)
- ↳ issued a gold coin - bull (power) + lotus (wealth) - to show he was the most powerful and wealthy king
- ↳ the theory of the gold coin was to emit a aura of power/peace when nation was in crisis
- ↳ thought of himself as only king, first independent ruler
- ↳ couldn't leave behind a dynasty after death



• 100 years of anarchy after Shashanka's death

Matsyanyay - [The Law of the Fish]

Matsyanyayam apakritum prakritibhir  
Lakshmiya karam grahitah Sri Gopala  
Pit kshatris - sirsam chudamani-  
tatsubha

To put an end to the state of affairs similar to what happens among fish, the prakriti (people) made the glorious Gopala, the crest jewel of the head of kings, take the hand of Lakshmi.

↳ big fish eat small fish

↳ time when self-claimed rulers fought with each other

• The Pal Dynasty (750-1150 AD)

- ↳ a local raja was democratically elected as king (local people voted)
- ↳ "Kopal er naam Gopal"
- ↳ Gopal was a Buddhist
- ↳ legend states that before Gopal, there were several kings in succession but they were consumed by Nagas - Gopal killed the Nag queen to earn the throne
- ↳ hence started the Pal Dynasty
- ↳ Gopal ruled from (750-770 AD)

↳ Mahipal II (1070-1075 AD) started restrictions on fishermen

(since the king was a follower of Buddhism, he thought it was wrong of fishermen to hunt and catch fish)

↳ Kaivarta rebellion (among fishermen) led by Divya (Pal employee)

↳ assassinated Mahipal II

↳ Kaivarta king ruled Varendra region (won by revolt) for half a century

↳ local mercenaries from Karnataka (employed by Pals as army chief) were loyal to the Pals, but quickly betrayed and formed Sen Dynasty.

→ upper class Hindus / Kshatriyas



## • The Sen Dynasty (1150-1206 AD)

- ↳ Hindus who started the caste system
- ↳ Lakshman Sen was the last ruler
- ↳ his downfall was predicted by an astronomer (defeated by a short, ugly man)
- ↳ Lakshman Sen couldn't care less

## • Establishment of Delhi Sultanates

- ↳ originates Turkey/Afghanistan
- ↳ sent Ikhtiar Uddin Muhammad Bakhtiar Khilji
- ↳ as local traders with 17/18 soldiers
- ↳ defeated Sen when he was in a harem
- ↳ start of Muslim Rule in Bengal
- ↳ Ikhtiar Uddin destroyed temples from Buddhist Bihar because his Afghan soldiers settled in with their family and hence needed comfort of what they knew (i.e. culture, mosques)

Sufism - distinct and personalised approach to Islam. Sufist message of universal brotherhood

## • There are 4 theories behind the arrival of Islam in Bengal / spread of Islam:

- ① forced conversion (cruelty, threat)
- ② To divert away from caste system
- ③ Socio-Political privilege
- ④ Influence of Sufism ← considered as primary reason

Bangla became a separate distinct language, not just a dialect of Sanskrit

↳ translation of great epics like Ramayana and Radha-Krishna's love story

## • Vaishnavism → a more direct approach to the supreme Godhead

- ↳ drew in people from both lower caste Hindus and Muslims (middle ground)
- ↳ late 15th, early 16th century
- ↳ transformative and liberative force
- ↳ allows participation of women outside their household chores
- ↳ it was founded by Chaitanya Mahaprabhu
- ↳ Vaishnavism did not originate from Vedism but emerged from a merger of several popular theistic traditions which developed after the decline of Brahmanism at the end of the Vedic period.

Following Lord Vishnu or Krishna

## • Bengal Sultanate

- ↳ said to be quasi-independent
- ↳ they worked under Delhi Sultanates
- ↳ however, during monsoon, the heavy rainfall made it impossible for the Delhi army to cross into Bengal to check in on the reign
- ↳ Monsoon gave the Bengal Sultanates a chance to rule independently
- ↳ since Bengal separates for a season
- ↳ back to working under Delhi Sultanates after season ends

apparently but not really; seemingly



## • The Mughal Rule

- ↳ initiated by Babur in 1526
- ↳ Akbar considered to be the greatest ruler of all time
- ↳ tried to be just, inclusive
- ↳ administrative process:
  - ① tax collection
  - ② redistribution
  - ③ allocation
- ↳ touched on every aspect of governance
- ↳ removed protection tax from all non-muslims
- ↳ held court with the Nine Gems (Navaratna) including Birbal
- ↳ sent trustworthy general Man Singh (Rajput) to take over local Bengal Zamindars/Lords/Bhuiyans
- ↳ Man Singh was:
  - ① renowned, strong
  - ② failed to bring all of Bengal under Akbar
  - ③ most of Bengal under Mughal Empire
- ↳ Jahangir → brings all of Bengal under Mughal Empire

implemented the Bengali calendar (which was created by King Shashanka)

Bhuiyan-raj denoted individual Bhuiyanship, whereas Baro-Bhuiyan denoted temporary confederacies that they formed. In times of aggression by external powers, they generally cooperated in defending and expelling the aggressor. In times of peace, they maintained their respected sovereignty.

↳ 1584/1586 AD

## \* Great Mughals

Babur → Humayun → Akbar → Jahangir → Shah Jahan → Aurangzeb → 1707 (passes away) an exhausted man

↳ most were not exact followers of Islam

↳ worst land under Mughal Empire (1689 AD)

EUROPEANS CREATE SMALL TRAINED & PAID CORPS OF SUBCONTINENTAL MERCENARIES TO PROTECT THEIR ECONOMIC ASSETS. HOWEVER, INCREASINGLY THEY USE THESE MERCENARIES TO INTERFERE IN THE INTERNAL AFFAIRS OF THE SUBCONTINENTAL KINGDOMS AND PRINCIPALITIES WHICH EMERGE/REEMERGE AFTER THE COLLAPSE OF CENTRAL RULE.

↳ by doing so, he spent far too much strength + money

↳ ironically, has weakened the central system → heirs fight among themselves

- ↳ Since the weakened system could no longer give protection to the foreign traders - they decided to employ "sipahi"/"sepoy" - mercenary troops
- ↳ Europeans created small trained & paid corps of subcontinental mercenaries to protect their economic assets (created by British and French)
- ↳ However, increasingly they use these mercenaries to interfere in the internal affairs of the subcontinental kingdoms and principalities which emerge/remerge after the collapse of central rule
- ↳ Sufi helped spread Islam and allowed Muslim leaders to rule
- ↳ Barobhuiyans (worked under Delhi Sultanates) were local governors of Bengals with their capital in Sonargaon + opposed Nawabs → Esha Khan, Musa Khan
- ↳ Barobhuiyans had the rights to collect tax, Nawabs wanted to take that tax from citizens.

MUGHAL INDIA IS WEALTHIER AND MORE PROSPEROUS THAN CONTEMPORARY EUROPEAN STATES INCLUDING BOURBON FRANCE

IN TIME, ECONOMIC POLICIES OF MUGHAL EMPIRE TURNS BENGAL INTO ONE OF ITS WEALTHIEST PROVINCES

ON PAR OR HIGHER THAN CONTEMPORARY SAFAVID AND OTTOMAN EMPIRES

## \* ALL FIGHTS IN THIS SUBCONTINENT WERE BASED ON LAND OR TAX

- Bengal became so rich and lucious, that French, Spanish and Europeans in general (Portuguese) came over to trade.
- Marathas used to attack Bengal regularly. (Ajit)
- Alivardi Khan → kills Sarfraz and becomes Nawab
- World Wide War between French and British.
- Sivajidatta announces war against British.

more of the story below

↳ Siraj-ud-Daulah

- last independent Nawab of Bangladesh
- he was 16 years old when he received power (with no struggle of succession at all)
- grandfather coup to take power (later legitimized by Mughal Emperor Shah Bahadur)
- flamboyant womaniser, heavily relied on his father (later dethroned Siraj-ud-daulah and became a Nawab of Bengal)

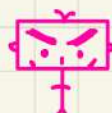
valiant administrator and experienced military commander  
grandson (transition unusual as it was without probations - shows the game of thrones)



- ↳ After the passing of Aurangzeb, different regions of the Indian subcontinent which had been provinces of Mughal Delhi quietly reasserts their independence
- ↳ Murshid Quli Khan (1710 AD) chief financial administrator of the Mughals of Bengal quietly detaches Bengal from direct rule - although they continue to pay trib service to the supreme authority of the Mughal Empire in Delhi (power and authority shrinking very rapidly)
- ↳ Khan was a capable administrator; completely re-organizes the system of governance in Bengal
- ↳ Gave people preference to people with ability; so there was no question of leaving out people from administration eg. religious terms
- ↳ capital is established at Murshidabad [Aurangzeb added the name "Murshid" to Quli Khan and subsequently gave him the power to change the name of the place]
- ↳ Nawabs of Murshidabad
- ↳ 1710-1757: Nawabs of Bengal who have re-asserted Bengali Independence once again.
- ↳ In 1717, the DEIC receives a license to trade with Bengal, duty-free  
the problem: only applies to the goods of DEIC and not goods purchased by individual officials of the DEIC
- ✓ One of the problems which causes tension between Bengal & British Empire leading upto the Battle of Plassey in June 1757.
- ↳ Bengal revenue officers frequently clash with British officers from DEIC (resigned from 1720-1722) immediately becomes Nawab (lost in law of Murshid Quli Khan)
- ↳ Murshid Quli Khan dies in 1727; succeeded by Shuja-Ud-Din; then Sarfraz Khan grandson: right to throne first, but his father challenged him for the throne - which he gave up without a fight; Nawab from 1737
- ↳ Sarfraz accused Alivardi Khan (advisor of Shuja-uddin of treason; he challenged Sarfraz to battle and killed him to become Nawab of Bengal (16 year reign) (in 1740) → Nopro
- ↳ The rule of Alivardi Khan was marred by maratha kingdom attacks (10 year reign of terror)
- ↳ 1751 AD: Bengal pays huge indemnity to stop attack
- ↳ Alivardi realized Europeans were fighting amongst themselves and did not want to get involved in European conflicts
- ↳ gave the condition that the British and French must not militarily fortify their trading bases
- ↳ In Bengal and the subcontinent, British violations of standing agreements with Bengal now lead to open conflict with Nawab Sirajuddaulah → leading to the battle of Plassey

## Murshid Quli Khan (The Land of Two Rivers)

- It was Murshid Quli Khan who gave this province the look of a settled country with a settle administration and general peace at the when when the Mughal Empire as a whole were fast becoming unsettled.
- He also tried to conserve Bengal's revenue and prevent its diversion. (honesty and competence)
- Bengal's economy grew at a fast pace backed by vigorous maritime trade and also thriving trade with the interior provinces, in both of which the European traders took the leading role supported by Bengali banians and Armenian intermediaries.
- Conflict with Aurangzeb's grandson, that made Murshid Quli transfer the dewani department of Bengal, with the emperor's permission, from Dhaka to Maksudabad, which was renamed Murshidabad. Murshidabad virtually became Bengal's capital.
- The administration had the stability from 1710 (after Khan was brought to Bengal) and now he was able to keep Bengal out of the general disorder that followed Aurangzeb's death.
- It was Murshid Quli Khan, not Lord Cornwallis, who was the founder of the zamindari system.
- Murshid Quli largely replaced the old zamindars and jagirdars, most of whom were upcountry Muslim nobles who had no vested interest in their estates and frequently defaulted in their revenue payments after misappropriating the funds
- Thanks to his encouragement of merit, a Hindu aristocracy consisting of zaminders, high government officials and wealthy merchants came to be established in Bengal by the first half of 18th century.





## # Nawab Siraj-ud-Daula and The Battle of Plassey.

Businessmen like Raj Ballav, Jagat Jati, Roy Desai, Anandchand helped BEIC and also betrayed Nawab (promised Nawab weapons but sided with BEIC)

What was the reason behind the betrayal of Ghaseti Begum and Mir Jafar during the Battle of Plassey?

Ghaseti Begum was a rival of Siraj-ud-Daulah's mother, Amina Begum. She had wanted her own son, Shaukat Jang, to succeed Alivardi Khan as Nawab of Bengal. When Siraj-ud-Daulah was chosen instead, Ghaseti Begum became resentful and began to plot against him.

Mir Jafar was angry with Siraj-ud-Daulah for dismissing him as paymaster general of the Bengal army. He had been expecting to be rewarded for his loyalty to the Nawab, but instead he was punished. This made him bitter and willing to listen to offers from the East India Company.

The East India Company offered Mir Jafar a large bribe to betray Siraj-ud-Daulah. They promised to make him the new Nawab of Bengal if he would help them win the Battle of Plassey. Mir Jafar was also afraid of Siraj-ud-Daulah's growing power. The Nawab was a young and ambitious ruler who was not afraid to challenge the East India Company. Mir Jafar feared that if he did not side with the Company, he would be the next one to be deposed.

All of these factors contributed to the betrayal of Ghaseti Begum and Mir Jafar during the Battle of Plassey. Their actions led to the defeat of Siraj-ud-Daulah and the establishment of British rule in Bengal.

In addition to the reasons mentioned above, there were also some personal factors that may have influenced Ghaseti Begum and Mir Jafar's decision to betray Siraj-ud-Daulah. For example, Ghaseti Begum was reportedly motivated by a desire for revenge after Siraj-ud-Daulah had executed her son, Shaukat Jang. And Mir Jafar may have been motivated by a sense of greed and ambition.

What was the reason behind Siraj-ud-Daula and the distance between his locals or his people?

There were a number of reasons behind the distance between Siraj-ud-Daulah and his locals or his people.

He was a young and inexperienced ruler. Siraj-ud-Daulah was only 23 years old when he became Nawab of Bengal. He had not had much time to learn the ropes of government, and he often made decisions that were unpopular with the people.

He was seen as aloof and arrogant. Siraj-ud-Daulah was not known for his charisma or his ability to connect with people. He often kept to himself, and he did not seem to understand the concerns of the common people.

He was seen as a puppet of the British. The East India Company had a lot of influence over Siraj-ud-Daulah. They were providing him with military and financial support, and they were also advising him on matters of state. This made many people believe that Siraj-ud-Daulah was not really in control of his own destiny.

He was seen as a threat to the power of the zamindars. The zamindars were the landed gentry of Bengal. They had a lot of power and influence, and they were not happy when Siraj-ud-Daulah tried to reform the system of land revenue. This led to a number of uprisings against the Nawab, and it further alienated him from the people.

All of these factors contributed to the distance between Siraj-ud-Daulah and his locals or his people. This distance made it difficult for him to maintain control of the province, and it ultimately led to his defeat at the Battle of Plassey.

What the reason for Mir Jafar's deal with the British during the Battle of Plassey?

Mir Jafar's deal with the British during the Battle of Plassey was motivated by a number of factors, including:

- ⑤ Greed. The British offered Mir Jafar a large bribe to betray Siraj-ud-Daulah. They promised to make him the new Nawab of Bengal if he would help them win the Battle of Plassey.
- ⑤ Ambition. Mir Jafar was ambitious and wanted to be the Nawab of Bengal. He saw the British as his best chance to achieve his goal.
- ⑤ Fear. Mir Jafar was afraid of Siraj-ud-Daulah's growing power. The Nawab was a young and ambitious ruler who was not afraid to challenge the East India Company. Mir Jafar feared that if he did not side with the Company, he would be the next one to be deposed.
- ⑤ Dissatisfaction. Mir Jafar was dissatisfied with his position as paymaster general of the Bengal army. He felt that he was not being rewarded for his loyalty to the Nawab. This made him bitter and willing to listen to offers from the East India Company.

The Battle of Plassey was a decisive victory of the British East India Company over the Nawab of Bengal and his French allies on 23 June 1757, under the leadership of Robert Clive. The battle took place at Palashi (Anglicised version: Plassey) on the banks of the Hooghly River, about 150 kilometres (93 mi) north of Calcutta (now Kolkata) and south of Murshidabad in West Bengal, then capital of Bengal Subah.

The battle was preceded by an attack on British-controlled Calcutta by Nawab Siraj-ud-Daulah and the Black Hole massacre. The victory was made possible by the defection of Mir Jafar, who was Nawab Siraj-ud-Daulah's commander in chief. The battle helped the British East India Company take control of Bengal. Over the next hundred years, they seized control of most of the rest of the Indian subcontinent, including Burma.

Here are some of the key events of the Battle of Plassey:

- The Nawab's army was larger than the British army, but it was poorly trained and equipped.
- The British army was led by Robert Clive, who was a skilled military commander.
- The British army was also supported by Mir Jafar, who had defected from the Nawab's side.
- The battle was fought on a rainy day, which favored the British, as their cannons were able to fire more effectively than the Nawab's cannons.
- The British army won the battle, and the Nawab was forced to flee.

The Battle of Plassey was a major turning point in Indian history. It marked the beginning of British rule in India, which lasted for over 200 years. The battle also had a profound impact on the Indian economy and society.

Here are some of the consequences of the Battle of Plassey:

- The British East India Company gained control of Bengal, which was one of the richest provinces in India.
- The British began to expand their control over other parts of India.
- The Indian economy was disrupted, as the British imposed taxes and regulations on trade.
- The Indian social order was also disrupted, as the British began to interfere in Indian customs and traditions.

The Battle of Plassey is a complex and controversial event in Indian history. It has been seen as both a victory and a defeat for India. However, there is no doubt that the battle had a profound impact on the course of Indian history.



## = FAKIR SANNYASI MOVEMENT = (1760s-1790s)

complex event with both  
anti-feudal & anti-colonial  
dimensions

- ↳ Fakir-Sannyasi Resistance - an armed resistance of the combined body of Muslim Fakir (sufis) and Hindu Sannyasis (yogis) against the dominance of the BEIC
- ↳ This resistance began in 1760 and continued for more than four decades.
- ↳ Both the groups of mendicants lived on alms provided by their followers mostly in the villages
- ↳ For hundreds of years, the fakirs and Sannyasis used to travel to North Bengal to visit various shrines and pilgrim sites. As a tradition, they used to collect a sizeable amount of alms from the local Zamindars.
- ↳ Before the battle of Plassey, the Zamindars had no problem in donating these alms and this collection of money was an amicable transaction.
- ↳ The British control over Bengal after battle of Plassey and Buxar led to an increase in land tax and exploitation of peasants.
- ↳ The government issued decrees banning collection of alms by the organised groups like the fakirs and sannyasis.
- ↳ In response, they started a resistance movement against the Company rulers. → anti-colonial/anti-feudal
- ↳ As per permanent settlement terms, lands of many of the old Zamindars were confiscated and given to new purchasers. New zamindars did not give alms since they were loyal to the British
- ↳ Numerous restrictions were placed on Sannyasis and Fakirs because the British considered them as looters and thugs
- ↳ The peasants, displaced landlords and Sadhu/Fakirs came together in a rebellion which started in later part of 18th century and continued for around half a century. → anti-colonial/anti-feudal techniques
- ↳ They raided government treasuries, killed British officers and caused acute chaos and misery.
- ↳ The Fakir-Sannyasi Resistance was organised and led by Majnu Shah, a sufi saint of Madaria sect
- ↳ Their main target was the Company kotha, revenue kacharis of zamindars loyal to the Company rulers and the houses of their officials.
- ↳ Their operations were mainly of guerrilla nature - they attacked the Company personnel and their establishments in surprise.
- ↳ Bhabani Pathak was a dacoit and a leader of the Sannyasi Movement in West Bengal. He was a large following in the downtrodden society and was acceptable much like Robinhood. He was killed by the British. Devi Chowdhurani led the Sannyasis after the killing Bhabani Pathak.
- ↳ Majnu Shah was also killed and after his death, his brother Musa Khan took the leadership and continued to rebel for some time. Later, Chirag Shah led the Fakirs to launch attack on British establishments. However, later internal dissensions became the reason for weakening of the revolt.
- ↳ The ex-army people provided leadership, peasants provided social base while the Fakir-Sannyasis provided a religious fervor to the struggle.

## = Tittumir Movement

- ↳ Tittumir was a Hafiz in Aurang. He excelled in three languages, Bengali, Arabic & Persian. He was well-versed in Islamic theology, jurisprudence, philosophy, tarikat (mysticism) & more. While in madrasa, Tita Mir grew up to be a good grammar and renowned wrestler (pashvon).
- ↳ On his return from pilgrimage in Mecca, he started preaching among muellers in the district of 24 Parganas and Nadia. He advised them to refrain from practising Shirk and inspired peasants and weavers to follow the Islamic way of life.
- ↳ Soon engaged in a conflict with Hindu zamindar Krishnadasa Rai for his arbitrary attack and imposing illegal taxes on them. → anti-feudal
- ↳ He was in conflict with more landlords as well.
- ↳ To face the situation, and to protect the peasants, Tita Mir formed a Mujahid force and trained them in lathi (bamboo stick) and other indigenous arms.
- ↳ The increasing strength of Tittumir alarmed the zamindars who attempted to take united stand involving the British.
- ↳ One zamindar was killed in conflict and a English force was banded back.
- ↳ Alexander, the collector of Burdwan, advanced against Tittumir and overhauled various debts.



- ↳ Titmish also filed a complaint to BEJC against the oppression of zamindars, without results.
- ↳ Titmish built a strong fort with wooden gates at Matalbari in October 1831, and recruited musketeers and gave them military training.
- ↳ Number of musketeers rose to nearly five thousand.
- ↳ Healy completed military preparation Titmish declared himself Sher Shah (king) and urged people to war against British.
- ↳ Established central zone districts of 24 Parganas, Nadia and Faridpur.
- ↳ Demanded fee from zamindars who called for protection from British.
- ↳ A contingent was sent from Calcutta but consisted forces of British and zamindars sustained severe defeat from English.
- ↳ Lord William Bentinck sent a regular army under Lieutenant Colonel Stewart consisting of 100 musketeers, 500 native infantry and artillery with two cannons.
- ↳ On 14<sup>th</sup> November 1831 the irregulars along with Titmish died on the hands of the army, who defeated them but why native weapons when they took shelter.

## INDIGO RESISTANCE MOVEMENT - (1859-1862)

- ↳ Indigo production and export was very profitable until value depressed in 1840s/50s ↳ anticolonial - against British
- ↳ Profit from indigo production became uneconomic at peasant (raiyyat) level objective - freedom from the oppression of planters
- ↳ Planters went bankrupt due to value depression and could not withdraw capital quickly so pressurized raiyyats to continue indigo production.
- ↳ Movement began in Jessore and Nadia in 1859 and continued till 1862 when the government interceded in favour of the raiyyats
- ↳ Discovery of American gold mines, Crimean War lowered profits for the plants plus cultivation of cereals, oil-seeds and jute paid better dividend
- ↳ The construction of railway lines through indigo districts led to a sudden rise in regional wages which was unmatched by planter's wages to the indigo labourers.
- ↳ Resistance ranged from general reluctance to non-cooperation (cutting off supply of daily necessities) to armed uprising.
- ↳ Christian missionaries were the most supportive
- ↳ All factors persuaded government to publish the Indigo Commission Report Act to prohibit the coercion of raiyyat for indigo cultivation and the measure led to the end of the movement.

## Farazi Movement

[First anticolonial then eventually anticolonial]

- ↳ The movement was against cruel zamindars who were all powerful, demanded unfair amounts of tax from peasants and increased rents irregularly. main objective
- ↳ The movement was to spread faraz of Islam and to encourage obligatory Islamic duties.
- ↳ The movement was led by Haji Shariatullah. ambiguous
- ↳ The movement was anti-feudal (and anti-colonial, since it eventually became against British). since it was against local higher class cruel zamindars so, it is against the system of ownership of resources. → done by peasants (mostly Muslims)
- ↳ The cruel Hindu zamindars along with the British officials resisted the movement.
- ↳ The movement was a failure since it was crushed as soon as it became a threat.

[https://docs.google.com/document/d/168yZ\\_Ay\\_bVHWI2IEh048fU1qorJ8ctUJpHGWtZsO9e/edit](https://docs.google.com/document/d/168yZ_Ay_bVHWI2IEh048fU1qorJ8ctUJpHGWtZsO9e/edit)

↳ Titmish, Farazi and ISA details



# SANTAL REBELLION

oscillating between both

good example on how a rebellion can be anti-feudal and anticolonial at the same time  
 anti-feudal → against their oppressors who went into their realm  
 anti-colonial → against British  
 gives most ambiguity

- ↳ Launched a highly organised armed insurrection against their oppressors who went into their realm to make themselves rich at their expense.
- ↳ The colonial state had once resulted them in moving from their original habitat to Rajmahal Hills
- ↳ But the colonial state agents came here to claim proprietary dues.
- ↳ Santal protests to uphold their natural rights - the one who cleared the land first was its master (respected during Mughal government too)
- ↳ Rebellion was triggered off when their leader Bir Singh was summoned to the kachari of Pakur Raj and mercilessly beaten and confined in chains in front of his followers
- ↳ Santals took an oath under the sal tree (representing unity and strength)
- ↳ Technique of guerrilla fighting
- ↳ Postal + Railway Communication severed; state agents driven off; railway labour contractors killed, rent payment to zaminders stopped and pledges to moneylenders negated by a declaration.
- ↳ Defeated military expedition under Major Burroughs
- ↳ Martial law was declared on 19 July 1855
- ↳ Most leading Santals were captured and executed
- ↳ Bengals were made to settle in Rajmahal Hills with proprietary rights to prevent any more Santal uprisings.

| Table - Summary: Resistance  |   |                                                                                        |
|------------------------------|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| • Tilak's Movement           | } | 1. anti-colonial or anti-feudal                                                        |
| • Indigo Resistance Movement |   | 2. main objective                                                                      |
| • Foresti Movement           |   | 3. who were involved, social class or which nationality or religious body and why them |
| • Santal Rebellion           |   | 4. Which identity was main                                                             |

points to consider



- British Rule (1600)

- ② Subalterni → controlling administration.  
(Robert Clive)

fight between → British East India Company  
→ Combined forces of Mir Jafar

Subeldari and not is this

it to the British.  $\rightarrow$  Dual System (দ্বৈত স্বায়ত্ত ব্যবস্থা)

like rain and snow, rain-snow is

He wanted to implement a unified tax to collect taxes from everyone, but was also transferred back.

which was implemented in 1793:

Permanent Settlement Act of 1793  
(Chowdhuri Bandobast Act)

random annual settlement  
system which was inefficient

✓ how the zamindar collects tax from his subjects or how much is upto him

✓ business class people (Many / More) changed and bought land from British.

- British was taking all the profits and allowing their own traders to transport goods without pay taxes (misuse of privilege) - angered Indian rulers (Mir Qasim & Sa'ad-ud-Daulah)
- Shah Alam II wanted to restore his own power

have jurisdiction over all British ships



- real zamindars lost land (anxiety)
- now local zamindars (Hindus) emerged with Bhangas etc.
- Divide and conquer (communal) problem introduced
  - ✓ given power to minority to create conflict with majority.
  - ✓ communal conflict due to political and religious reasons.

## → Social Stratification

- Zamindars knew that everyone was paying tax properly and on time.
- they started asking money for religious purposes, marriages, pujas, etc.
- zamindar asked another person to collect tax.
- He started asking for extra money to get rich.
- He asked another person to collect tax, too.
- so, farmer had to pay tax to three separate people at once.

This created the social stratification.

This still exists in a manner in today's villages.

## → New Institutions Rules

improved communication systems, tents, railways, hospitals, schools built, etc.

## → Cash Crops: impact of permanent settlement act

- create some crops that cannot be made anywhere else (cash crops. skill, labour, eg. indigo, opium)
- farmers were told that this will create a bridge between European and this subcontinent.

The Permanent Settlement Act of 1793, which was implemented in Bengal and Bihar, incorporated communalism in a number of ways.

- It created a class of wealthy landlords who were predominantly Hindu. The zamindars, who were given the right to collect land revenue from the peasantry, were mostly Hindu, while the vast majority of the peasantry were Muslim. This created a situation where the Hindu zamindars had a vested interest in maintaining the status quo, while the Muslim peasants were disproportionately disadvantaged.
- It led to the concentration of land ownership in the hands of a few. The zamindars were able to accumulate large amounts of land, often through subinfeudation, which is the process of leasing land to tenants who then sublease it to even smaller tenants. This concentration of land ownership made it difficult for the peasantry to improve their economic conditions.
- It exacerbated religious tensions. The zamindars often used their position to discriminate against Muslim peasants. For example, they might charge them higher rents or deny them access to irrigation water. This led to resentment among the Muslim peasantry, which contributed to the growth of communalism in Bengal.

The Permanent Settlement Act was a major factor in the development of communalism in Bengal. It created a system in which the Hindu zamindars had a disproportionate amount of power and influence, while the Muslim peasantry were disproportionately disadvantaged. This situation led to resentment and conflict between the two communities, which ultimately contributed to the partition of India in 1947.

In addition to the above, the Permanent Settlement Act also had a number of other negative consequences, such as:

- It led to a decline in agricultural productivity. The zamindars were not incentivized to invest in agricultural improvements, as they were guaranteed a fixed amount of revenue from the peasantry. This led to a decline in crop yields and an increase in rural poverty.
- It contributed to the growth of corruption. The zamindars often used their position to extort money from the peasantry. This corruption further impoverished the peasantry and led to social unrest.
- It hindered the development of a modern economy. The Permanent Settlement Act created a system that was based on exploitation and privilege. This hindered the development of a modern economy in Bengal, which was ultimately detrimental to the entire region.

### Rise of Kolkata

- Bhadrakalok class → mostly Hindus who accepted education in English Medium. Muslims were against it (out of opinion) → Muhammadan Literary Society + Madrasah.
- Kolkata was the economic hub since British moved their headquarters there.
- new institutions made to facilitate the British; but enhanced Kolkata.

## # SEPOY MOVEMENT - (1857)

- first war of independence / Great Mutiny
- racism, discrimination between British and non-British
- tied soldiers in front of cannons and fired to kill
- bodies left to decompose.

- 1: Economic concerns - Sepoys were paid less and treated with disrespect.
- 2: Political concern: British had increasing control over India.

(1 reason) <sup>(Guns spread)</sup> Religion reason: cartridge of Enfield gun was covered with fat of pig and cow and caused rebellion among muslim and Brahmin / Shatriya sepays since they had to use their mouth to reload.

- North India → concentration / epicenter (later went national)
- Sepays went Shah Jafar who was in Delhi. They offered to make him leader / king of India if he helped to drive off the British. (He was crowned too)
- Punjab and most of Bengal were loyal to British
- Gurkha movement (regiment sent to Bengal) - ideal soldiers from Nepal who were loyal to British
- when the sepays lost, at one point British arrested Shah Jafar
- Hiding at the grave of Humayan.
- The man who arrested Shah Jafar - Major William Hodson killed all his sons and grandsons publicly and exiled his wife to Myanmar, Rangoon
- Upon their death, Mughal Dynasty officially ended.

**AFTER THIS REBELLION IN 1857, BRITISH GOT SCARED**  
**TOTAL INDIAN SUBCONTINENT IS NO LONGER UNDER BEIK**  
**→ BRITISH CROWN TAKES OVER**



# BRITISH RULE: 1858 - 1911

It led to the dissolution of the East India Company, and forced the British to reorganize the army, the financial system, and the administration in India, through passage of the Government of India Act 1858. India was thereafter administered directly by the British government in the new British Raj. On 1 November 1858, Queen Victoria issued a proclamation to Indians, which while lacking the authority of a constitutional provision, promised rights similar to those of other British subjects. In the following decades, when admission to these rights was not always forthcoming, Indians were pointedly refer to the Queen's proclamation in growing avowals of a new nationalism.

- ↳ Everyone inevitably becomes a subject of the British Crown
- ↳ British Crown sent a viceroy
- ↳ During this time, a lot of improvements took place in the land -

- political scopes increased
- significance of modern education
- Mohamadan Literary Society

- Balanced out power between Hindu and Muslim

- ↳ Aligarh Movement → lead by Sir Syed Ahmed Khan
  - this lead to Aligarh University
  - establish a modern system of Western-style scientific education for the Muslim population of British India

After the failure of Sepoy Movement

- ↳ Deobandi Movement → by working class
  - showed an anti-communal attitude
  - against BEIC and British Crown

- ↳ In 1861, Indian Councils Act was created (12 members)

- ↳ In 1892, Indian Councils Act → around 100 members

- ↳ power: led to reorganised solutions to problems to the Viceroy
  - ✓ gave Indians position in the Council
  - ✓ Bengal presidency given importance

- ↳ Hunter Commission (1882) → gave more importance to primary education among locals, and for all.
  - came to an understanding with the missionaries
  - missionary schools start to bloom
  - took initiative to make primary schools.

appointed by the government of India  
✓ a consequence of Sepoy Mutiny

## Indian Congress

- ↳ In 1885, a British civil servant named Alan Octavian Hume form a party for Indians
- ↳ hence All India Congress Party was formed

- now the nature of Congress is secular + communal party (like BJP)
- members were Kolkata-centric upper cast Hindu family (majority) + elite Muslim family
- Jinnah joined Congress but left when found out that they were against Muslims

had extremists from both Hindus and Muslims; there were secular members

## First Partition of Bengal (1905) - 1905

↳ Oct 16, 1905

- ↳ Lord Curzon, Viceroy of India (1899-1905) executed the partition of Bengal.
- ↳ came to Dacca and divided Bengal → Dacca became capital of Eastern Province

### Eastern Province

- East Bengal
- Assam
- Muslim majority

### Western Province

- West Bengal
- Bihar
- Orissa
- Hindu majority

Official Reason shown: (legitimate but not the real goal)

remainder v Partition  
Hindu v muslim

- To bring politics under control
- To solve administrative problems due to large province
- socioeconomic development

Kolkata was already developed with 22 schools, court...  
East Bengal would get Dacca Uni + Chittagong port after partition

✓ Underlying reason: To make Bengal politically unstable (divide and conquer)

## Muslim revivalism movement - 2 Str

- ↳ a revival of the Islamic religion, usually centred around enforcing shariat (duty)

loyal to the British

- ↳ showed no anti-communal attitude

from a

privileged class

The Deobandi movement was a revivalist movement within Sunni Islam that emerged in British India in the late 19th century. It was founded by Mughammad Qasim Nanotwi and Haidar Ahmad Gangohi, who sought to reform Islam and revitalize the Muslim community in the face of British colonial rule.

The Deobandi movement had two main aims:

To purify the pure teachings of the Quran and Hadith. The Deobandis believed that many Muslims had strayed from the true teachings of Islam and had adopted practices that were not in accordance with the Quran and Hadith. They sought to revive the study of these sacred texts and to teach Muslims how to live in accordance with their teachings.

To keep alive the spirit of jihad against foreign rulers. The Deobandis believed that it was the duty of Muslims to fight against any ruler who oppressed them or who tried to interfere with their religious practices. They supported the Indian Rebellion of 1857 against British rule and continued to preach jihad against foreign rulers throughout the colonial period.

The Deobandi movement was successful in spreading its teachings throughout British India and beyond. It established thousands of madrasas (religious schools) and produced a large number of scholars and preachers. The Deobandi movement also had a significant impact on the political development of South Asia. Many of the leaders of the Pakistan Movement were Deobandis, and the movement continues to be influential in Pakistan and other parts of the world today.

Here are some of the key characteristics of the Deobandi movement:

Orthodoxy: The Deobandis adhere to a strict interpretation of Islamic law (Sharia) and reject any innovations (bid'ah) that they believe are not in accordance with the Quran and Hadith.

Piety: The Deobandis emphasize the importance of personal piety and religious observance. They encourage Muslims to pray regularly, fast during Ramadan, and give charity.

Traditionalism: The Deobandis reject Western influences and seek to preserve traditional Islamic culture and values. They are opposed to modern education and social reforms that they believe are incompatible with Islam.

Jihad: The Deobandis believe that it is the duty of Muslims to fight against any ruler who oppresses them or who tries to interfere with their religious practices. They have supported jihad against foreign rulers throughout history, and some Deobandi groups continue to preach violence today.

The Deobandi movement is a complex and multifaceted one. It has had a significant impact on the development of Islam in South Asia and beyond. While some of its views and practices have been controversial, the Deobandis remain a major force in the Muslim world today.

## Recommendations:

- Introduction of compulsory primary education for all children between the ages of 6 and 12.
- Establishment of a central education authority to oversee the development of education in India.
- Introduction of a system of grants-in-aid to private schools.
- Promotion of female education.



## Eastern Province

- muslims: happy for division
- lower/worker class farmers

## Western Province

- educated class
- privileged class
- zamindars
- power
- new insecurity for zamindars:  
their lands were in the eastern province

Reality → class problem (zamindars v farmers)  
Disguised by → religious problem (hindu v muslims)

- ↳ all the Congress Politicians were extremists in nature
- ↳ when the partition happened, they protested
- ↳ shift in economic power since East Bengal will no longer need to go to Kolkata for jobs/health
- ↳ protests were initially peaceful in nature eg. petition  
→ soon shifted to religious acts - ganga snann, ganesh puja, rakhi

Rabindranath gave two songs  
for national anthem of Bangladesh

- ↳ জাতির সোনার বাংলা
- ↳ ইন্দ্রেন্দ্র বুদ্ধের ওরা

- ↳ Educated class (middle/privileged) realized the real motivation behind partition.  
So, they started to protest.

## # Swadeshi Movement: The first successful movement done by the educated class.

- ↳ Purpose:
  - ✓ To annule the partition.
  - ✓ To keep Bengal united.
  - ✓ To defeat the British.
  - ✓ Establish self-rule (outsiders cannot rule).

Gandhi was not the leader, he was in South Africa till 1914, but he did inspire the movement.

to put financial crisis/pressure on British

started by Krishna Chandra Mitra

Congress adopted this politically later to boost Indian Economy in 1905

- ↳ Initiatives:
  - ✓ Boycott British products.
  - ✓ Engage in civil disobedience.
  - ✓ Stop giving service to British.
  - ✓ Commit political assassinations.
  - ✓ Revolutionary Party

boycott movement was fierce because Indian businessmen with British products fought against protestans

## ↳ Zamindar group:

- ✓ We want to continue zamindari.
- ✓ Not to make less tax.

## ↳ Politically educated group:

- ✓ Under British divide, so we must let them.
- ✓ wanted to defeat British
- ✓ new Bengali Nationalism

Diplomatic: Some  
✓ Inspired by Irish  
✓ lost high rank British officers (Clerks to do so)  
✓ killed relatives  
✓ religious duties to British  
• These nationalist movements later influenced more nationalist movements  
• Diplomatic followed two rules:  
✓ Take up in the name of Kali  
✓ Sing Bhadrakalpa everyday

Elite muslims also protested because they didn't want their land seized.

religious issues also excluded muslims from the Swadeshi movement

## # Rise of Muslims

- ↳ particularly hard for muslims of Eastern Bengal to support the Swadeshi movement, because:

- ✓ They were considered second class citizen by everyone
  - ✓ Seen as lower class. (like we see Rohingyas)
  - ✓ Congress is not supporting them, especially eastern province
  - ✓ Language was borrowed from Hindu mythology
  - ✓ Baste Mahataram slogan
- muslims faced insecurities due to these and thought these were against them

Response by muslims PTO



## Response:

- ✓ All India Muslim League formed (30<sup>th</sup> December 1906) at a conference in Dhaka.

## Meeting decisions:

- ✓ it is clear that Congress do not care about us
- ✓ we do not get enough priority from Congress
- ✓ upper caste Hindus get priority from Congress
- ✓ we need a committee to take care of us.
- ✓ separate political platform needed for Muslims.

↳ All India Muslim League  
→ later, Muslim League  
→ turned out to be more communal

## # All India Muslim League

- ↳ British convinced Nawab Sir Khwaja Salimullah to form All India Muslim League;
- ↳ gave high positions to elite Muslims
- ↳ Mohammad Ali Jinnah was one of the flagbearers of Muslim League  
→ he proposed the Lahore Resolution (23rd March 1940)

← previously a member of the Congress Party

A historic Resolution was passed on 23rd March 1940 for establishment of a separate homeland. Muslims shared one vision, one dream of freedom and work for it and succeeded against all odds, to share one homeland we call Pakistan!

↳ We see two types of nationalism:

- ✓ Hindu nationalism
  - ✓ Muslim nationalism
- } objective: get rid of British

## # Morley-Minto Reform (1909)

- ↳ affected by Swadeshi Movement, Congress, Muslim League
- ↳ Legislative Council members were increased from 16 to 60
- ↳ A quota/electorate was kept just Muslims
- ↳ Muslim League was very happy and welcomed this decision
- ↳ Council members can now not only suggest but also vote/change policy  
↳ permitted to discuss budget, suggest amendments and can vote on them.

## Congress had two types of reaction to the reform

- | moderate                                                                           | extremists                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- agrees</li> <li>- make secular</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- against this (rejected)</li> <li>- upper caste Hindus → didn't want anyone in power</li> <li>- must have separate decision from Congress and Muslim</li> </ul> |

↳ Mohammad Ali Jinnah  
→ who plays a pivotal role later

© Mahatma Gandhi

↳ London for studies, then went to South Africa (involved in activism)

## → Annulment of Partition

- ↳ In 1911, British declared the annulment of the partition
- ↳ previously the capitals were Dacca and Kolkata, and now the capital shifted to New Delhi



# THE OPPOSITION TO BRITISH RULE:

1912 - 1947

## \* World War I (1914-1920)

- ↳ Had a big effect on our subcontinent
- ↳ our British soldiers involved there → lack of man power
- ↳ Anti British parties rise in Indian subcontinent when British were busy / pressure in Europe / Biplobi groups eg. Jugantar, Anushilan shomites (revolutionary group) → often very violent
- ↳ Maulana Bhashani (young) was one of such groups
  - ↳ used to attack zamindar kuthi
  - ↳ once attacked a zamindar in Kishoreganj to burn tax documents. Back in those days, there was a tradition of generational debt. So when Bhashani's group attacked the zamindar's house, he burned all the tax documents and consequentially freed the farmers from debt since there was no proof / evidence of documents. This was their strategy.
- ↳ Hence British were concerned about them. Both Hindu and Muslim Nationalists wanted to chase British away
- ↳ Sindh Letter Movement
  - sindh + Mahomed al Hasan from Deoband sent a letter to the Ottoman Empire to help them be free of the British but the letter was leaked and the involved parties were sent to exile.

## \* World War I (part 2) - KHILAFAT MOVEMENT

- ↳ Ottoman allied with Germans, against the British during the war
- ↳ Ottoman loses WWI
- ↳ The then Khalifa Badshah was the sultan of the Ottoman Empire
- ↳ Upon losing, British
  - imposed a lot of conditions on his rule
  - which resulted in the restriction of his power
  - seized a lot of his territory eg. loses Jordan, Palestine, etc.
- ↳ British came over and talked with Al Saud (king of Saudi Arabia) and agreed to an arrangement
- ↳ they will support Al Saud so they stay against the Ottoman and exit the Ottoman shade

So how did Saudi Arab become a dominant power source in the Muslim world?

- ↳ British involved involved + colonial past
- ↳ couldn't exist without the help of British colonialism
- ↳ British made an arrangement with the Arabians - come out of the Ottomans and they will ensure that Saudi Arab becomes a separate country
- ↳ When the Khalifa was imposed with restrictions, there were protests all over the world's muslim community
- ↳ most protest happened in India → Khilafat movement (against British)

Demand:

1. return Khalifa status
2. don't take Ottoman into this unfair, unjust arrangement



## # Rowlatt Act (1919):

consequence of Swadeshi Movement (Congress)

[after Gandhi came into the scenario and entered politics]

- ↳ to punish those who want British away
- ↳ gave unprecedented power to the police
  - ↳ if the police suspects anyone to be a traitor, even without evidence, they had the power to arrest and question indefinitely, inapplicable bail

- ↳ Muslim/Congress protested against this Act
- ↳ claimed that it was an unfair rule
- ↳ political parties got the upper hand and framed opposition, doesn't matter traitor or not

very similar to current Digital Security Act - to catch and harass political opponents and against one's own will

## # Jallianwala Bagh Garden Massacre: 13th April, 1919

- ↳ Amritsar, Punjab, British India
- ↳ public peaceful gathering at Baisakhi mela
- ↳ families, children, elderly, hugely innocent
- ↳ Crowd were peacefully protesting against Rowlatt Act
- ↳ Entire area was surrounded by high rise wall/tall building; only one narrow passage at an entrance
- ↳ British army entered fair and blocked exit with troops
- ↳ They opened fire and kept firing until they ran out of ammunition
- ↳ casualties: 350 - 1500 ; injured: over 1200
  - British claim
  - actual
- ↳ Formed piles of dead bodies, many tried to climb walls, scratches still visible
- ↳ Some jumped into a well to save themselves, loads died drowning (120 bodies found)
- ↳ British thought they did a good deed and were happy

In 1919, Huq was chosen as a member of the Punjab Enquiry Committee along with Motilal Nehru, Chittaranjan Das and other prominent leaders which was set up by the Indian National Congress to investigate the Amritsar massacre.

Sadar Uddham: kills the British behind the massacre in front of everyone

- even larger protest all around British India due to this
- ↳ Gandhi took lead of Congress

Muslim: Khilafat movement against British

Congress: protesting against Rowlatt Act

Gandhi supported this to enlist muslim support

★ Gandhi saw this and proposed: why don't we merge together and make one movement?

## # Non-Cooperation Movement

- Goals:
- stop cooperating with British
  - stop going to court or giving service to British
  - no cooperation in their administration

- ↳ Gandhi was fueled by the Amritsar Massacre too, and influenced by the Swadeshi Movement

- ↳ Gandhi's political strategy: Satyagraha

core principle:- no violence whatsoever

→ first implemented in a protest in South Africa

- ↳ no violent action
- ↳ establish national institution
- ↳ boycott British
- ↳ no service, no help, no products



- ↳ It was a very successful movement
  - spread to all of India
  - Hindu-Muslim together again
  - successful movement, influential
  - peaceful movement

self-reliance became  
a political culture

↳ British were now cornered:

- agreed to reform in some aspects
- agreed to meet or consider some demands because:
  - they were facing economic loss
  - people rejected imported British products
  - raw materials unused

by making own  
clothes

↳ Chauri Chaura Incident at Uttar Pradesh (1922)

- there was an ongoing peaceful protest about the non-cooperation movement
- police attacked and killed three civilians
- infuriated protesters attacked the police in return
- police took shelter at the police station which was set to fire by the protesters
- all occupants (22 policemen) were killed

↳ British Government blamed Gandhi for the incident since it went against Gandhi's peaceful protest policy.

↳ Gandhi took full responsibility and stopped the Non-Cooperation Movement

some appreciated this; others did not

## # Swaraj Movement → Hindu-Muslim Unity

- ↳ Chittoranjnan Das (CR Das) genuinely wanted to unite Bengal (Hindus + Muslims)
- ↳ didn't want non-cooperation movement to end
- ↳ CR Das and Motilal Nehru formed Swaraj Party (Congress - Khilafat Swaraj Party)

- Goal:**
- swaraj establishment - self rule
  - offers a proposal to East Bengal → Bengal Pact, 1923
  - council member seats will

Bengal Pact, 1923 an agreement aimed at resolving the question of Hindu-Muslim differences.

be distributed by  
noting population majority  
• so muslims will get majority  
of seats if they are  
higher in numbers

(previously 90% - hindu +  
10% muslim)

- Representation in the Bengal Legislative Council would be on population basis with separate electorates.
- Representation in the local bodies would be on the proportion of 60 per cent to the majority community and 40 percent to the minority community.
- Regarding Government appointments, it was decided that fifty five percent of the appointments should go to the Muslims. Till the above percentage was attained, 80 per cent of posts would go to the Muslims and the remaining 20 percent should go to the Hindus.
- No resolution or enactment would be allowed to be moved without the consent of 75 percent of the elected members of the affected community.
- MUSIC in processions would not be allowed in front of the mosques.
- No legislation in respect of cow killing for food would be taken up in the Council and endeavour should be made outside the Council to bring about an understanding between the two communities. Cow killing should be taken up in such a manner as not to wound the religious feelings of the Hindus and cow killing for religious purpose should not be interfered with.

had a different approach  
than congress → only  
violence will give freedom  
he even fought against  
his own army

chairman of  
congress for 3 days

↳ Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose supported the Pact, but Gandhi did not.

↳ Pact was rejected by Indian National Congress in December, 1923

↳ The death of CR Das resulted in a strike down upon Hindu-Muslim Unity and the quick abolishment of the Swaraj Party. (1925)

Soon after its announcement, the Pact created a great outcry among Hindus and Muslims in Bengal. Its bold provisions offended middle class Bengali Hindus who opposed it stubbornly because they thought that the implementation of the Pact would diminish their power and influence in political as well as in administrative spheres.

CR Das's family was so wealthy, they used to send laundry overseas to France to wash and launder, but CR Das sacrificed a lot.



- ↳ Rest of India: • lower caste/class (dalits) faced oppression/aggression
- has limited rights - were a big issue
  - who claimed to have the right to form a party to address their issues
  - movements started for rights of lower caste

- ↳ Champion on the lower caste: Dr. Ambedkar (Buddhist)
- educated, struggled to reach where he is, no doubt in his credibility
  - tried to do a movement with the dalits
  - writer of the Constitution of India

## # Government of India Act, 1935 (later rejected)

- ↳ give India dominion status
- ↳ must keep British Parliament supremacy
- ↳ army control with British

In the Indian subcontinent, the significant year for the establishment of electoral politics is 1935. The Government of India Act of 1935 introduced important electoral reforms, providing for the election of representatives to the legislative bodies at the provincial and central levels.

Key features of electoral politics during the Indian subcontinent in 1935 include:

**Provincial Elections:** The Act allowed for the establishment of provincial legislative assemblies, with a certain number of seats to be filled through direct elections. These assemblies had the power to make laws and handle provincial matters.

**Separate Electorates:** The Act introduced separate electorates based on religious communities, which meant that Muslims, Sikhs, and other religious minorities would have their own reserved seats in the legislative bodies. This policy of communal representation aimed to safeguard the interests of different religious groups.

Simon Commission report was boycotted  
Communal award 1932; Congress and other parties had reservations  
The Government of India Act, 1935 passed in the Parliament  
Responsible govt. with adult franchise

General election was held in 1937 under this Act

### Features:

- Abolition of diarchy at province, introduction at centre.
- Indian Council replaced by an advisory body.
- All India Federation with British India territories and princely states.
- Safeguards and protective instruments for minorities.
- Supremacy of British Parliament.
- Increase in size of legislatures, extension of franchise, division of subjects into three lists and retention of communal electorate.

In both Congress and Muslim League, the politicians were either upper caste Hindus/Muslims, from a privileged background and zaminders.

## # Muslim League and Krishak Sramik Party

- ↳ Jinnah and AK Fazlul Haque were both part of Congress
- ↳ they both moved to All India Muslim League, where Fazlul Haque was the president
- ↳ but after a clash with Jinnah, Haque moved to lead the Krishak Proja Party
- ↳ Jinnah did not suspend Fazlul Haque because he was too influential [Jinnah was governor general]
- ↳ centred around working class/peasants/Krishak
- ↳ Haque promised to abolish Proja Shotto Ain if he became Chief Minister
- ↳ **main objective:** • they started advocating to reform this system - abolish zamindari/permanent settlement act system - popularity spread very soon in Bengal
- wins Legislative Assembly Election 1937 in coalition with Muslim League

- ↳ In 1938, KPP changed its name to Krishak Sramik Party (KSP)
- ↳ Hindu Mahashobha was an extremist party
- ↳ when the election took place, KSP took part in 1936
- ↳ KSP won 36 seats which was not the majority number of seats to form a government
- ↳ british governor advised for a coalition government
- ↳ so Congress has to join either ML, KSP or HM
- ↳ Congress won't ask ML for ideology difference, so Congress offered to KSP - who denied
- ↳ ML offered to KSP, Fazlul Haque denied

Jinnah was originally from Gujarat. He had all his assets in India but he shifted from Congress to ML because of shift in political ideology.

Jinnah wasn't even fluent in Urdu - he spoke in English



- ↳ this is because the party proposing the coalition will have its leader as president
- ↳ so later, KSP gave a proposal to ML, so that Fazlul Haque can be president and ML accepted
- ↳ this government was never destined to last long since Jinnah was insulted
- ↳ so one year later, ML withdrew support - to make the current government collapse
- ↳ Haque wanted to stay in power, so he had to sacrifice his ideology
- ↳ so he proposed a coalition government with Hindu Mahasabha
- ↳ but HM gave a condition that there will be 6 ministers from HM and 5 ministers from KSP
- ↳ HM forced some initiatives against Muslims eg. not to sacrifice cows in public
- ↳ Haque could not hold ideology, so he resigned
- ↳ meanwhile Congress isn't supported by anyone
- ↳ so now ML offered coalition lead, Haque agreed
- ↳ so the Chief Minister is now Khawaja Nazimuddin
- ↳ Haque was given Relief and Disaster Management Ministry
- ↳ so when the famine hit in '43 (Second Greatest Famine in Bengal)
- ↳ British charged Muslim League for all the deaths
- ↳ Meanwhile, ML blamed Haque since he was in charge of the ministry
- ↳ In the end, British ultimately suspended the entire government

#### Demands of KPP

- ✓ abolition of the zamindari system
- ✓ peasants' absolute proprietorship of land
- ✓ reduction of land rent rate
- ✓ giving interest free loans to peasants
- ✓ creating irrigation facilities; digging canals
- ✓ introduction of free primary education, etc.

## # World War II (1939) : fought between allies and axis

↳ Muslim League showcases Lahore Resolutions (লাহোর প্রস্তাব)

USA

UK

Soviet Union

etc.

Germany

Italy

Japan

Finland

etc.

All India Muslim League held a conference on 22-24 March 1940 in Lahore

Sir Sikandar Hayat Khan drafted Lahore Resolution that was presented by A. K. Fazlul Haq

Two Nation Theory: sovereign states for Muslims

"...with such territorial readjustments as may be necessary that the areas in which the Muslims are numerically in a majority as in the North Western and Eastern Zones of (British) India should be grouped to constitute 'independent states' in which the constituent units should be autonomous and sovereign."

direct effect

Muslim different nation/race } so we cannot stay together  
Hindu different nation/race

↳ areas in which Muslim are in numerically a majority, (as in North Western & Eastern Zones) should be grouped to constitute "independent states".

↳ autonomous & sovereign



## # Cripps Mission: (1942)

a diplomatic mission in which Sir Stafford Cripps was sent to India by Winston Churchill (the then prime minister of Great Britain) to ask for army soldiers / reinforcements from Mahatma Gandhi, with the promise that if they win the war and the war ends, Britain will give him an autonomy:

- ✓ India will be independent
- ✓ Army chief of India shall be Viceroy (they won't give up military)

British needed more army forces as they were travelling from one land to another, colonising, and losing troops, so Churchill sent Cripps to negotiate with Gandhi

- In April 1942 Sir Stafford Cripps was sent to Delhi
- Offered independence of India; a constituent assembly and more seats in Viceroy's executive council

Congress (Gandhi) and PM Churchill opposed the mission's proposal.

→ understood something was risky

→ thought we are giving too much to India

- ✓ Gandhi started Quit India movement in August, 1942.
- leave us independent
- ✓ Congress leaders and Gandhi arrested for the movement.

### Cripps Mission & Quit India Movement



Sir Stafford Cripps enjoys a joke with Mr. Gandhi on his diplomatic mission in India, surrounded by Indian journalists and photographers

- In April 1942 Sir Stafford Cripps was sent to Delhi
- Offered independence of India; a constituent assembly and more seats in Viceroy's executive council
- Emphasized not to pressurize any part of the country to join independent India
- Congress and British PM Churchill opposed the mission's proposal
- Failed mission led to 'Quit India' movement in August 1942

### Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose & the Azad Hind Fauj

#### Azad Hind Fauj or Indian National Army (INA)

- First formed in 17 February 1942; initiatives by Imperial Japanese Army
- Subhas Chandra Bose arrived in Singapore in 1943 and revived the Army
- Netaji allied with the Axis powers in WWII
- INA gave hope for the freedom and self-governing rights in India



Subhas Chandra Bose with Japanese Prime Minister Hideki Tojo at a parade for Indian national independence at Singapore



## # Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose

- ↳ One of the most influential politicians of Bengal
- ↳ initially used to work with CR Das (sort of his actual mentor)
- ↳ influential leader during his time in Congress [because when he stood in election, Gandhi did not like this]
- ↳ election → chairman so influential *chairman of congress for a day*
- ↳ Subhas and Gandhi had their differences in some aspects: for Gandhi, non violent means to any end were non-negotiable; in Bose's thought, all means were acceptable in the service of anti-colonial ends.
- ↳ Politically radical when it's about India's independence *(reason no point in negotiating)*
- ↳ He would start freedom movement (war) if needed - without negotiation
- ↳ **Main objective:** drive British away [his violent approach was opposite to Satyagrah]
- ↳ His desperation led him to take a controversial step: **going to Hitler during WWII**
- ↳ said, "Look, enemy of my enemy is my friend. You don't want British. I don't want. So why don't we help each other out?"
- ↳ went to Singapore (then under Japanese Imperial Army) (previously under British)
  - a lot of prisoners of war (British) including Indian prisoners.
- ↳ he asked them, "Why are you working for British? They are making you ... Don't stay loyal to the British, come with me, we will liberate India."
- ↳ Famous slogan, "you give me blood, I give you freedom. Soldiers agreed."
- ↳ Azad Hind Fauj / Indian National Army (INA) [17 Feb, 1942] formed with prisoners of war
- ↳ dedicated to liberate India from British
- ↳ INA gave hope for freedom and self governing rights in India
- ↳ mainly assisting Japan / Axis powers → axis forces lost in WWII
- ↳ Azad Hind force disperses at that
- ↳ SCB dies in a plane crash - lots of controversies about his death
- ↳ A body was found which was burned beyond recognition
- ↳ there were rumors of seeing him later while there was no solid evidence of his death
- ↳ The Great Bengal Famine of 1943 is a good example of how cruel the British oppression was to the point that it drove Netaji to deal with a person like Hitler who was cruel and racist.

### ↳ Why did Azad Hind Fauj (INA) disperse?

- The death of Subhas Chandra Bose: Bose was the founder and supreme commander of the INA and his death in a plane crash in 1945 was a major blow to the morale of the army.
- The surrender of Japan: Japan, which had been supporting the INA, surrendered to the Allies in 1945. This left INA without a major sponsor.
- The lack of International Support: The INA was not recognized by any major international power and this made it difficult for them to obtain supplies and weapons.
- The lack of popular support in India: The INA did not have widespread support among the Indians and this made it difficult for them to sustain their operations.



## # The Great Bengal Famine of 1943:

- ✓ Land till Burma was under Japan.
- ✓ Food like rice was imported from Burma.
- ✓ Under Japan, food supply from there decreased.
- ✓ It was still manageable: we had enough food to tackle the famine even amidst the malnutrition.
- ✓ British soldiers needed food and ration and that was given more priority.
  - ↳ food taken from Burma
  - ↳ boats were taken away as well
  - ↳ Local British officers repeatedly warned against this.
  - ↳ "We don't have enough resources to tackle the famine."
  - ↳ Winston Churchill didn't give a shit about this.

• Man-made famine  
• Natural disaster aggravated by administrative failure when rice export to Bengal from Japanese occupied Burma dried up  
• Rice taken for British army  
• Boats were confiscated by the British and inland waterways trade stopped  
• Market prices, widespread corruption and shortages

- ✓ Winston Churchill was directly involved behind initiating the famine.
- ✓ Around 1-3.8 million people died in the famine out of starvation.
  - ↳ they died directly due to WWII, but were never counted as war casualties.
  - ↳ Churchill did not take blame for this, but it is his fault.
  - "This is not our fault, this is because Bengal's breed like rabbits." was Churchill's answer when people put the blame on him.

## # Wavell Plan & Shimla Conference:

- ✓ was the first plan/proposal after WWII of how to make India gradually independent
- ✓ Wavell was the new Viceroy.
  - ↳ called a conference at Simla on 25<sup>th</sup> June 1945.
  - ↳ aimed to discuss the future of India with British administration.

- ↳ The proposal:
  - All India Executive / Legislative Committee (all India representative, separate Hindu & Muslim representatives) (Muslim majority areas will have muslim representatives.)
  - Some things (eg army) will be in British hands (dominion state)
  - Separate quota kept for the depressed class (lower class)
  - Congress / Muslim League both not for them (disagreeing)
  - Jinnah / Gandhi both not in support. (they realized real intention)
  - Wavell Plan failed
  - Wavell left, new Viceroy placed.

another reason why

- ↳ The issue of representatives:

- Jinnah demanded muslim representatives to be solely under Muslim League.
- Congress disagreed (cannot make Muslim League sole representative of muslims) (they also have some muslim politicians.)
- If Pakistan is not made, Jinnah wanted all muslim representatives
- No middle ground reached between Congress & Muslim League.



## # The election of 1945-1946:

- ↳ Areas of muslim majority, Muslim League won in votes over there.
- ↳ Jinnah's demands now has more rock-solid proof and evidence.
- ↳ Vague map/outline of Pakistan can be visualised.

## # Cabinet Mission, 1946:

- ↳ Last plan given by British that did not involve partitioning
- ↳ Tried to incorporate demands of both Congress & Muslim League
- ↳ The plan:
  - Indian subcontinent stays as one country
  - Independence will be given eventually
  - Three tier system government: Tier A, B and C

Provincial, Group and Central govern

↳ most power

very weak (Delhi): self-defense; foreign policy

- so that provinces have sovereign statuses

- ↳ Initially both congress and muslim league agreed
- ↳ Soon debates came up:
  - Congress: why provincial government had so much power; give more power to central governor
  - Muslim League: wanted more power to provincial government

- ↳ No middle ground was achieved
- ↳ British agreed to an election to solve this
- ↳ Muslim League withdrew its support, so only Congress participated in election and ultimately, the British sided with Congress
- ↳ Now, • Jinnah claimed British betrayed them by siding with Congress

- Direct Action Day (all India riot)

- most conflict in Calcutta [The Great Calcutta Killing] [the week of a knife]

- ↳ Muslim League announced general strike on 16th August 1946

- ↳ Widespread communal riot between Muslims & Hindus

- ↳ Estimated 4000 people died

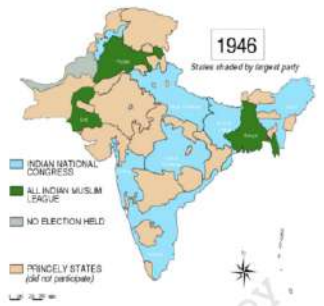
- ↳ Sowed the seed for Partition

- ↳ more communal division

- ↳ also riots in Noakhali among Hindu Muslim

- ↳ Gandhi arrived to save the problem and both sides respected him.

### Elections of 1945-46



3 ministers assigned by the cabinet mission were responsible to look after British India

|                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Three-man cabinet deputation to New Delhi                                                 |
| Transfer of British power to a single Indian administration                               |
| Proposed a three-tier federation for India                                                |
| Local provincial governments can opt out                                                  |
| Primarily both ML and Congress agreed                                                     |
| Nehru: no Constituent Assembly could be "bound" by any prearranged constitutional formula |
| Muslim League withdrew its support                                                        |

no discussion

- Jinnah requested Muslims to approach West Bengal/Bihar without any arms or weapons → for it to be a peaceful protest
- But the Hindus attacked saying Muslims of armed enemy
- in 7 days 4/5k Muslims were slaughtered both in West Bengal and Bihar
- the outcome was the Hindu-Muslim riot

## # Proposal of United Bengal

- ↳ Both Congress and Muslim League agreed:

- one united province or separate country
- some people in second

- West Bengal (mainly Congress) did not want united Bengal; wanted to stay with India if needed.

Huseyn Shaheed Suhrawardy, the Premier of the province of Bengal, formally launched this idea

Sarat Chandra Bose proposed for a Sovereign Socialist Republic of Bengal

Most provincial Congress and Hindu Mahasabha leaders wanted Bengal partition

The Direct Action Day aggravated communal tension

asked to draw a map for India-Pakistan; with no previous knowledge of border separation

### Partition Plan & the Radcliffe Boundary Commission

- Boundary Commission created in July 1947

- The commission was appointed by the British Government

- Chaired by Sir Cyril Radcliffe

- To recommend how to divide Bengal and Punjab between India and Pakistan

- Sparked mass migrations

- When there was a country I searched for freedom. Now I am free, but have to search for a country



During an historic conference in New Delhi, Lord Mountbatten and the main Indian leaders agree upon the partition of India according to a British plan. At the conference, from left to right: Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru, Lord Jinnah, co-chairman to Lord Mountbatten and India's viceroy, and M. A. Jinnah.

Congress: Muslim majority areas to go to Pakistan; Hindu majority areas to stay in India. But Gandhi wanted the partition.

## # Refugee Crisis

- ↳ world's biggest refugee crisis
- ↳ huge number of people abducted and raped
- ↳ train full of corpses from India to Pakistan and vice versa.



# COLONIAL ATTACKS ON LANGUAGE AND CULTURE OF BANGLADESH

## # Creation of Pakistan:

- ↳ So the **Two Nation Theory** that Jinnah had declared at Lahore in 1940, came to life through the creation of Pakistan. [Term coined by Rahmat Ali]
- ↳ But the big question was: **What would happen to Bengal?**
- ↳ That was when **Suhrawardy** proposed to have **United Bengal** - which would prevent Bengal to be divided on religious grounds but transform it into an undivided, sovereign state called **the Free State of Bengal**.
- ↳ However, Congress (i.e. Nehru) asked what would happen if there is a Hindu majority on one side - then the Muslims will take revenge.
- ↳ A **confessionalist** (politics + religion) political system was mooted (put up for debate).
- ↳ Suhrawardy's initiative was not put to realization since local leaders retaliated.
- ↳ Congress went door to door promoting the Partition.
- ↳ The proposal was not put up for vote and Suhrawardy gave in since he needed to think of the country rather than die trying to control local riots.
- ↳ Politics started to suffer from an internal clash.
- ↳ While the British government proceeded to partition Bengal in accordance to the Mountbatten Plan and the Radcliffe Line.
- ↳ So **East Bengal** was added to Pakistan → **East Pakistan**.
- ↳ Initially, we all, including **Bangabandhu** supported in making Pakistan:
  - ✓ no upper class / zamindar (who used to rule us)
  - ✓ Pakistan will be land of eternal Eid (happiness all year round)
  - ✓ It will be a land exploitation free (non-harshness muslims also supported this).

"Hindus and Muslims belong to two different religious philosophies, social customs and literary traditions. They neither intermarry nor eat together, and indeed they belong to two different civilizations which are based mainly on conflicting ideas and conceptions."

→ East Pakistan vs. West Pakistan  
divided along the border  
proposed by Jinnah

### Mountbatten Plan

- Sikhs, Hindus and Muslims in Punjab and Bengal legislative assemblies would meet and vote for partition if a simple majority of either group wanted partition then these provinces would be divided.
- Sind and Baluchistan were to make their own decision.<sup>[34]</sup>
- The fate of North West Frontier Province and Sylhet district of Assam was to be decided by a referendum.
- The separate independence of Bengal was ruled out.
- A boundary commission to be set up in case of partition.

When Pakistan unfolded,

- ↳ East Pakistan and West Pakistan had a few **fundamental differences**.
- ✓ The first challenge: how to lessen fundamental differences.

← ethnic composition differences →

## # East Pakistan:

- ✓ Almost everyone in one ethnic identity: **Bengali**
- ✓ Indigenous people are the only minor ethnic group.
- ✓ **Bihari**:
  - migrated from India during partition
  - urdu speaking
  - most of them were from working class / middle class
  - ✓ went into farming, food business, some were industrialists

## # West Pakistan:

- ✓ carriers of different ethnic groups, so diverse
- ✓ Punjabi, Pashtun, Sindhi
- ✓ **Muhajir**:
  - migrated from India to West Pakistan
  - urdu speaking
  - a big chunk of Muhajir was **upper class**
    - ✓ may have been zamindar in India
    - ✓ may have been industrialists
    - ✓ " " " bureaucrats / higher ranked officials
- Domination of Muhajirs in positions of power:
  - ✓ Dominants
  - ✓ army
  - ✓ parliament
  - ✓ party
- Experienced upper rank officials.



## # Differences between the two wings of Pakistan

↳ But the only thing holding East and West Pakistan together was religion.

The dissimilarities between the two wings include:

- ethnic build up
- tradition
- social behaviour pattern / belief
- language
- culture
- economic activity

### West Pakistan

- predominantly muslim
- Sikh / Hindu shifted during partitioning due to:
- hostile environment
- more non-communal practice

### East Pakistan

- Hindu group stayed (most)
- less hostile environment (relatively)
- more religious diversity (relatively)
- most of legislative council was hindu / non-muslim
- communal problems

↳ Liaquat Ali Khan was the first prime minister of Pakistan (1947)

↳ Khan was a part of All India Muslim League led by Jinnah and consequently helped Jinnah in the Pakistan Movement (to create a separate Muslim nation state out of a Hindu majority India)

↳ He demanded that the developing Pakistani constitution will be based on the ideology of Islam.

↳ Khan was later assassinated in 1951 by Said Akbar (Afghani hired assassin, who was immediately shot down by the police)

## # Language Struggle:

↳ Immediately after the creation of Pakistan, the dissimilarities and the distance between the two wings was prominent

↳ They wanted to create a sense of nationalism, but required:

- same language, culture, religion, ethnicity in the two wings
- no common ground except religion.
- decided to establish lingua franca / common language
- announced In 1947, URDU will be state language
- Bengalis started protesting against this immediately.

Why? The wide differences between the two wings

and to achieve common goal

The insecurity Pakistan faced:

- ✓ More than 50% of population of Pakistan Bengali speaking
- ✓ Punjab > Pakistan > Sindh > Urdu
- ✓ Urdu was spoken by 3%
- ✓ Bengali was rich in literature.

↳ Hence language was thought to be the political tool that unifies Pakistan - lingua franca

↳ However, when Prof. Ziauddin Ahmed proposed the state language to be Urdu, there was an immediate backlash from East Pakistan.

↳ who considered this an attack on culture through language since only 3% of the population spoke in Urdu while more than 50% spoke in Bengali

↳ So, why Urdu?

Upper class / Muslim's language was Urdu

- ✓ They wanted to impose Urdu as state language.
- ✓ They wanted to protect / strengthen their elite status.

but in a secret letter, Jinnah apparently admitted he wanted provincial / state language to be Bengali - the letter was sealed.

reason showed

- ① Urdu is more alive with Islam
- ② claimed Bengali is Hindu's language

"The state language, therefore, must obviously be Urdu, a language that has been nurtured by a hundred million Muslims of this sub-continent, a language understood throughout the length and breadth of Pakistan and, above all, a language which, more than any other provincial language, embodies the best that is in Islamic culture and Muslim tradition and is nearest to the languages used in other Islamic countries..."

→ quoted by Jinnah



# Ashraf / Ahrat class system: a conversion of the Hindu caste system to the Muslims

| <u>Ashraf</u>                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <u>Ahrat</u>                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• came from middle east</li><li>• Arabia / Baghdad / Afghanistan</li><li>• claimed to be "more" muslim</li><li>• whoever came from overseas had this superiority complex</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• converted locals</li><li>• Ashraf claimed they were less muslim</li><li>• Can they even read the Quran?</li></ul> |

✓ Ashraf class wanted Urdu to be state language.

✓ Reasons shown:

- ahrat became muslims recently
- not much knowledge on Islam
- elite class: so in position of power.
- we are original land owners.
- Used Ideological state apparatuses to implant the idea.

✓ During the Pakistani Movement, Subhanwady, Shaikh Mujibur Rahman, Bhutto / muslim league / supported.  
Some Bengalis supported it → they Ashraf Ahrat.

✓ 1948 → student protests, but not much result

✓ 1948 and later: students united and started movement

↳ main mobilization by students, unlike previous movements

↳ students protesting in lead for the first time.

# Tamaddun Majlish: (the organization that first addressed the ridiculous decision) → muslim intellectuals (principals/scientists)

- ↳ This was an Islamic non-political, cultural organization established in 1947 [Principal Abul Kaseem]
- ↳ And was one of the founding organizations to contribute to Bengali language Movement
- ↳ They released a pamphlet titled Pakistaner Rashtra Bhasha: Bangla na Urdu? which sparked discussion between the population
- ↳ They demand Bangla to be one of the state languages of Pakistan
- ↳ The pamphlet's proposal demanded:

➤ Tamaddun Majlish played the pioneering role to protest against the attempt of making Urdu as the only state language of Pakistan.

➤ Tamaddun Majlish issued a booklet on 15 September 1947 titled Pakistaner Rashtra Bhasha: Bangla na Urdu (Pakistan's State Language: Bangla or Urdu) edited by Professor Abul Quasem.

➤ Tamaddun Majlish took initiatives to form the Rastrabhasha Sangram Parishad (State Language Committee of Action) on 1 October 1947.

1. Bengali should be:

1. the medium of instruction in East Pakistan;
2. the court language of East Pakistan; and
3. the official language of East Pakistan.

2. Urdu and Bengali should be the two official languages of the central government of Pakistan.

3. Bengali should be the first language for the purpose of education in East Pakistan, to be learned by all the people;

1. Urdu may be treated as the second language or inter-province language in East Pakistan, which can be taught as a second language to those people who will be working in West Pakistan. It will be more than adequate if Urdu is learned by only 5% to 10% of population of East Pakistan. Urdu may be taught in higher classes at the secondary school level in East Pakistan; and
2. English should be the third or international language of East Pakistan.

4. Both English and Bengali should be used for a few years as the official languages in East Pakistan. ❌

Revival of Muslim community  
↳ like muslim revivalistic movements during the British Era.

✓ Similar to Mohammedan Literary Society  
✓ worked with uprising of muslim community

# Syed Mujib Ali:

↳ Professor of Begum college

↳ had to face a lot of oppression & repression due to this

↳ When he was in Pakistan, he was called Indian dalal, here to break Pakistan's unity. When he went to India, he was called a Pakistani dalal → here to break the unity of India.

↳ Wrote a novel in East Pakistan's state language.

↳ Predicted Bengalis will resist if they are forced → it's never a good idea to enforce language on a country

↳ Showcased an example involving Arab and Iran, which result in him facing a lot of pressure: Threats from Pakistani Administration

↳ He had to leave to Kolkata and return after independence.



- ✓ State Language Action Committee formed ✓ Leaders: student
  - ↳ separate language committee for students
- ✓ All Party State Language Action Committee.
  - ↳ Bangabandhu was part of this movement.
  - ↳ He was NOT a leader of this movement / committee
  - ✓ Students were the leaders (e.g. Abul Muttin, etc.)

helped to form by Tanazzul Majlis

helped to form by Anami Muslim League

### # Dicendranath Datta:

→ taken from slides

- ↳ 1948 : Keep Bangla as state language besides English and Urdu. → **REJECTED**
- ↳ 1949 : Bangla to be state language of just East Pakistan, not entire Pakistan.
  - ↳ But, students rejected it: they wanted Bangla to be state language of entire Pakistan.
- ↳ He was a part of the constitutional committee to draft the legislative framework of the new country before the actual independence of Pakistan
- ↳ Datta represented his constituency as a Hindu member in the Pakistan National Congress
- ↳ In 1948 during the Pakistan Constituent Assembly, he demanded the use of Bangla along with Urdu and English for conducting Assembly Proceedings

### # Student Action Committee (SAC):

- ↳ SAC was a student-led organization that played a pivotal role in the Bengali Language Movement.
- ↳ The SAC was formed in 1948 by a group of DU students who were concerned about the government's plans to make Urdu the sole state language of Pakistan.
- ↳ The SAC organised protests, strikes and other forms of civil disobedience to demand Bengali to be recognized as a state language.
- ↳ Their main functions were to:
  - organize and coordinate protests and demonstrations in support of Bangla
  - disseminate information about the language movement to the public
  - raise awareness of the importance of Bengali language and culture
  - lobby government officials to recognize Bengali as a state language
- ↳ The SAC's efforts were instrumental in the success of the Bengali Language Movement. The movement culminated in the tragic death of several students on February 21, 1952 but it ultimately led to the recognition of Bengali as a state language. The SAC's work helped to ensure that Bangla would continue to be the language of East Pakistan and it laid the foundation of the eventual independence of Bangladesh.

### # Education Commission's Report Regarding the State Language

- ↳ In 1947, the EC had recommended Urdu to be the lingua franca of Pakistan
- ↳ Since it had historical links with Arabic, Persian and Sanskrit
- ↳ The report also argued that Urdu was a modern language that could be used to communicate with the rest of the world
- ↳ This was controversial since East Pakistanis wanted Bangla as national language
- ↳ In the end, the government of Pakistan decided to make Urdu the sole national language
- ↳ However, Bangla was also recognized as a state language after the protest of 1952. This compromise helped to maintain peace and stability in the country, despite the linguistic diversity of its population.
- ↳ The revised key point of the report included:
  - Urdu should be the lingua franca of Pakistan
  - Urdu should be used as the medium of instruction in schools and universities
  - Steps should be taken to promote the use of Urdu in government and other official spheres.
  - Bengali should be recognized as a state language.



Q: Why was the language movement / protests comprised of students specifically?

- Ans:
- they never learned Urdu since childhood
  - state-related jobs and facilities will require proficiency in Urdu, students will get deprived of these job opportunities in the future
  - because of language, students will get marginalised even though Bengali is majority
  - classmates who can speak Urdu, even if they have less IQ merit, will get job in higher positions, but more meritorious cannot
  - many recruitment question papers were made entirely in Urdu no Bengalis were recruited
  - Bengali ethnic community marginalised so they cannot get into positions of power.

- ✓ Bengalis realised nothing changed after British left.
- ✓ They thought Hindu zamindars caused all the real problems.
- ✓ Now, true nationalists who call themselves Muslims were also marginalising them.
- ✓ Bengalis in the Muslim League did not give Bengalis a priority, looked towards Urdu.
  - ↳ gave priority to West Pakistan / Muhajir.
  - ↳ claimed Muslim League is not our Muslim League.
- ✓ Some politicians, former Muslim League, united by Maulana Abdul Hamid Khan Bhalochani with Suhrawardi formed the Awami Muslim League.

reasons for forming the Awami Muslim League

### # East Pakistan Awami Muslim League:

- ↳ In 1949, Awami Muslim League was founded in Rose Garden of KM Das Lane
- ↳ Muslim League did not prioritise general people (সাধারণ জনগণ) (শ্রমিক জনগণ)
- ↳ So, another muslim league needed for general, normal people, who will prioritise them. (Awami → people)
- ↳ Awami Muslim League was formed
- ↳ It was a counter of Muslim League.
- ↳ After 1954 election, the word "muslim" was omitted to make it more inclusive and welcoming to other religious communities; by Maulana Bhalochani
  - learned politics from CR Das and Molag; Subhash Chandra Bose.
- ✓ in order to be non-communal

#### # Formation of Awami League

- ↳ In 1955, the Awami Muslim League dropped the word "Muslim" from its name, becoming Awami League
- ↳ This was a symbolic gesture that showed that the party was no longer a religious party, but rather a secular party that represented the interests of all Bengalis, regardless of their religion and promoted Bengali nationalism.

- ↳ The party was founded by Bhashani, Haque, Suhrawardy and so on
- ↳ Bangabandhu was made the Joint Secretary since he had been playing an integral part in the language movement
- ↳ And so was brought into central politics personally by Fazul Haque, from Chopalgonj.
- ↳ At its birth the party adopted a 42 point programme with special emphasis on the demand for provincial autonomy (প্রাদেশ স্বায়ত্ব)
- ↳ Recognition of Bengali as one of the state languages of Pakistan, one man-one vote, democracy, framing of a constitution, parliamentary form of government, regional autonomy and removal of disparity between the two wings had been the major demands of Awami Muslim League at Political Party Assembly and parliament. → but not much profit or outcome
- ↳ The AML played a leading role in the formation of the "All Party State Language Action Committee" in 1952, preceding the 21st February killing.



- ✓ 1952 January → same demand: Urdu will be the only state language of Pakistan.
- ✓ Language Movement was now at peak.
  - ↳ more radical initiatives
  - ↳ more strikes and unrests.
- ✓ Pakistani Government announced curfew on 20<sup>th</sup>, 21<sup>st</sup> and 22<sup>nd</sup> February.
- ✓ Abul Matin, leader, urged students to break curfew and protest at Dhaka Medical.
- ✓ University professors and lecturers requested students not to break curfew or the laws and protest.
- ✓ Abul Matin refused to stop and kept going.

## # 21st February 1952:

On 21 February 1952, students in Dhaka, East Pakistan gathered to protest the government's decision to make Urdu the sole state language of Pakistan. The protest was organized by the Student Action Committee (SAC), which had been formed in 1948 to demand that Bengali be recognized as a state language as well.

- They faced conflict by the police, who lathi-charged. School/college students joined as well, which was a huge panic for the police.
- However, lathi-charge, tear gas had no effect on them, they couldn't be dispersed.
- The protest was met with a violent response from the police, who opened fire on the students. Several students were killed, including Abdus Salam, Abul Barkat, Rafiq Uddin Ahmed, Abdul Jabbar, and Shafiur Rahman. These five students are now known as the Language Martyrs of Bangladesh.
- A nine-year old girl was killed amidst the fire as well, as collateral damage.

The deaths of the Language Martyrs sparked widespread protests and demonstrations across East Pakistan. The impact of the Language Movement of 1952 was far reaching. It helped to raise awareness of the language issue and to mobilize public support for the Bengali language movement. The movement ultimately succeeded in its goal of making Bengali a state language, and it is considered to be one of the most important events in the history of Bangladesh.

The Language Movement also had a significant impact on the development of Bengali nationalism. It helped to create a sense of common identity among the people of East Pakistan and it laid the foundation for the eventual independence of Bangladesh in 1971.

Plan of Pakistan: enforce Urdu to initiate Pakistani Nationalism.

Reality they faced: failed to enforce Urdu instead started growth of Bengali Nationalism.

**A NATIONWIDE MOVEMENT**



- The reaction to the police killings in students' procession was immediate.
- All over the country, schools and colleges held protest meetings, rallies and processions.

**BENGALI NATIONALISM**

- Language movement was the first among the series of movements during Pakistani period.
- It raised the sense of Bengali nationalism.
- Account on language and culture accelerated protest against Pakistan.



**ATTACK ON CULTURE CONTINUES**

- Demand for status of state language for Bangla continues
- Though Bangla was considered as a state language in 1956 constitution the assault on Bengali culture continued.
- During Ayub era the idea of writing Bangla in Roman script was propagated.
- Considering the poems and songs of Rabindranath Tagore as against values of Pakistan state government stopped broadcasting those in Radio Pakistan in 1967.

**ATTACK ON CULTURE CONTINUES**

- Bangla New Year Celebration, *Pohela Baishak* was considered as a festival of the minorities, the Hindu community.
- These attitudes of the Pakistani rulers were clearly as attack on the Bengali culture.
- *Chhayanaout* came forward to practice Rabindra songs and Rabindra-thought, in spite of various obstacles.

*Important*



# CAPITALISTIC DEVELOPMENT AND REGIONAL DISPARITY IN PAKISTAN

**# Capitalist Development:** The developments that directly help with industrialisation.

- We are all working class due to this system
- problem of capitalist society: workers get less in return than the amount they work
- while upper class get paid more while doing no work at all
- For e.g. factories, infrastructure, road and so on. Even studies can be considered.
- ↳ how? Engineering: helps in building/maintaining industries/factories
- Hence most demand is met.
- Because they help in capitalist development.

- ↳ **Karl Marx:** famous for how he interrogated/assessed capitalists.
- ✓ methods still used today
  - ✓ says that how a society is formed depends on their economic mode and on those control the economy
  - ↳ depending on that, different classes emerge
  - ✓ According to Marx, history of human kind is history of class system
  - ↳ different economic work at different times
  - ↳ and hence different social classes
  - ↳ and these social classes always compete with one another.
  - ↳ the oppressed always try to move to the top
  - ↳ the ones on top try to oppress the ones below

- ✓ During Marx's time world was so full with food it was supposed to be impossible to be in hunger. Then why is there so much hunger and pain?
- ✓ Marx explains because of property owning and exploitation.
- ✓ The problem of capitalist society.
- ↳ new form of upper class lower class conflict

## Historical Context:

- Economic system during the British period → Feudalism   
 where, an owner's main dependency was agriculture by peasant class   
 • sometimes passed on farmers
- Because of trade and colonialism, Indians now have a lot of money (BESC/merchants)
- In order to produce and supply goods more efficiently, they came up with an idea to build factories.
- Industrial revolution in Europe: - we were dependent on agriculture. - we will now produce whatever we need
- Faster production.
- No longer kisthik-dependent
- Workers needed to work at factories
- Now, power NOT in the hands of Rajas or colonialists, power is in the hands of rich businessmen and industrialists/capitalists
- New economic model → industry driven
- Power of things increased, industrialists have more power and money/influence.
- But they kept us in feudal system, did not shift to capitalist system
- Why? They can take money to Britain
- Hence, in South Asia, especially Pakistan before partition, we saw capitalist development.

- # Pakistan:**
- it was not modern when Pakistan emerged.
  - no capitalist development
  - stuck in a feudal structure.
  - West Pakistan: slightly better infrastructure
  - compared to west Pakistan, East Pakistan wasn't much developed.
  - higher class / industrialists situated in the west
  - Concentration on capital more in West Pakistan.
  - Economic imbalance between the two wings
  - ↳ central Pakistan government also wanted capitalism to be stronger in Pakistan.
  - ↳ hence why they relied on capitalists

## INITIAL CONDITIONS: EAST & WEST PAKISTAN

- ② West: slightly better roads, railways irrigation & power
- ② East: fertile land, high rainfall, well developed system of waterways
- ② Both wings had very low industrial capacity though EP had a strong rural handloom industry
- ② Low educational attainment in both wings
- ② But WP had strong army; and Muslim civil bureaucrats and Muslim traders from India emigrating to WP



- House move allowance given to Punjabis / Urdu-speaking Muhajirs
- State - financial help given, so that they can industrialise
- As a result development in Karachi / Islamabad happened more rapidly than Dhaka / East Pakistan
- Evidence of this is seen in the economic disparity between the two wings
  - ✓ gradually economic disparity between two wings increases
  - ✓ If development was centered around general people, disparity would have tapered.
  - ✓ Clear evidence of the imbalance between the wings

From 1949/50, disparity increased 3 times by 1970

Before: Exploited by Hindu zamindars and British Raj  
After: Exploited by West Pakistan

Before: We thought it was a problem of religion  
After: It is a problem of ethnicity / race

→ Hence why Bengali Nationalism started to grow inside us.

- More industrialization in West Pakistan using state money
- Even if some industrialization is done in East Pakistan, most of it is under control of non-Bengalis
- Export / import business also in non-Bengali hands
- Tea garden / jute mill here, but owner in West Pakistan

→ Juteby workers: no proper wages

gets money doing nothing

very unique in terms of world history

- same country exploiting its own state was unique
- very first time why liberation war

✓ New form of colonialism: inter-state colonialism

→ economic exploitation

→ economists warned, but no one listened

✓ From the birth of Pakistan, USA used to provide a lot of funds for development.

→ why? USA needed more allies who abide by capitalist ideology

→ USA and Russia cold war: USA capitalist; Russia communist

espionage; tension; USA wanted to be capitalist more

✓ Pakistan used to rely on USA / West since the beginning

✓ USA: help Pakistan in every way possible and ensure they develop under capitalist grounds

→ Pakistan will be an ideal capitalist model that USA can show off.

→ only an image of West Pakistan shown.

✓ By the end of the 60s, huge difference between lifestyle.

But huge money and resources used to come from East Pakistan.

\* Rise of 22 families: Top 1% most wealthy families

- 1 family was Chittagong / Bengali
- Industrialists / Influential
- e.g. Ispahani, Ashraf

✓ Problem in the system, because top 1% controlling everything.

✓ Development in West Pakistan more.

✓ 6-point demand is how to decrease economic disparity and bring the two wings to equality

## ECONOMIC CONDITIONS OF EP IN 1947

- 2 Metropolitan Kolkata and East Bengal hinterland
- 2 Hindu zamindars and Muslim tenant and small holder farmers
- 2 Trade, commerce, financial intermediation and rural industries dominated by Hindus
- 2 Tea industry and mechanized river transport owned by British
- 2 Bureaucracy, teaching and legal professions in EB dominated by Hindus
- 2 Bengali Muslim expectation of advancement through Pakistan

## GROWTH OF DISPARITY: PER CAPITA INCOMES

| Year    | East Pakistan Rupees | West Pakistan Rupees | Disparity (2-1) | Disparity ratio 2-1x100 |
|---------|----------------------|----------------------|-----------------|-------------------------|
| 1949/50 | 288                  | 351                  | 63              | 21.9                    |
| 1954/55 | 294                  | 365                  | 71              | 24.1                    |
| 1959/60 | 277                  | 367                  | 90              | 32.5                    |
| 1964/65 | 303                  | 440                  | 137             | 45.2                    |
| 1969/70 | 331                  | 533                  | 202             | 61.0                    |

Source: Sahib, Rahman, From Two Economies to Two Nations: My Journey to Bangladesh (Dhaka: Daily Star Books, 2015)

## CAPITALIST ECONOMIC PLANNING IN PAKISTAN

- 2 Harvard Advisory Group celebrated capitalist development in Pakistan as model against socialism (1968)
- 2 The Decade of Development (1958-68): Impacts
  - ✓ regional inequality
  - ✓ income inequality and impoverishment of peasantry & workers
  - ✓ rise of 22 families (only 1 from EP)
  - ✓ powerful bureaucracy and army
  - ✓ affluent urban upper class

a propaganda group of the then government

did not highlight the crisis within

## THE SIX POINT PROGRAM: 1966

1. Federation of Pakistan based on the Lahore Resolution; and a parliamentary form of government directly elected on the basis of universal adult franchise.
2. Federal government controls only two subjects - defense and foreign affairs. All other subjects vested in the federating states.
3. Two separate, but freely convertible currencies for two wings. If this is not feasible, then one currency for the whole country, but effective constitutional provisions to stop the flight of capital from EP to WP.
4. Power of taxation and revenue collection vested only in the federating units, not the federal center.
5. Two separate accounts for foreign exchange earnings of two wings; each empowered to establish trade links separately with foreign countries.
6. East Pakistan to have a separate military or paramilitary force, and navy headquarters should be in East Pakistan.



- ✓ Besides capitalist development, at the same time we are witnessing a resistance against it
- ✓ Tebhaga Movement: against zamindari system  
1/3 movement
  - started before partitioning

- continued even after partition / after 1947 in Bangladesh
- KSP: also against capitalist development
  - behaviour in Marxism

Main concern: just because you own it does not mean you will have all profit from it

#### Curiosity read:

Tebhaga Movement was the sharecroppers' movement demanding two thirds of the produce from land for themselves and one third for the landlords. Tebhaga literally means 'three shares' of harvests. Traditionally, sharecroppers used to hold their tenancy on fifty-fifty basis of the share of the produce. In land control parlance such crop sharing system was known as barga, adhi, bhagi, etc., all meaning half share. The sharecroppers were commonly called bargadars, adhiars etc. The traditional system of dividing the produce between the sharecroppers and owners came under challenge in 1946-47, when the sharecroppers called the traditional system unjust and claimed two-thirds share of the whole produce on the ground of their investment and labour input. During the winter or aman harvest of 1946, sharecroppers of some north and northeastern districts of Bengal and their supporters had gone to fields and cut down crops and thrashed them on their own khalan (harvest processing field).

On two counts the action was indeed an insurrection. First, they demanded that the half-sharing system was unjust and unjustified. Since all the labour and other investments were made by the tenants and since the landowner had virtually no participation in the production processes in terms of capital input, labour and infrastructure, the latter should get at most one-third of the crops, not one half. Second, the tenants were traditionally required to stack the harvests at the owner's khalan (thrashing floor) and share the straw and other by-products on half-sharing basis. The tenants refused to obey this. They argued that the harvests would be stacked at the tenant's compound and the landlord would not get any share from the by-products.

Tebhaga movement was organised mainly by the communist cadres of the beggar provincial Kishorek sabha. Under their leadership the barga (sharecropping) peasants were mobilised against the landlord class. Tebhaga movement spread out to nineteen districts of Bengal. However, the movement was most intensely felt in the districts of Dinajpur, Rangpur, Jalpaiguri, Khulna, Mymensingh, Jessore and the 24-Parganas. As expected, the landholders had refused to accept the terms dictated by their tenants. They called in police and caused many of the tebhaga activists arrested and jailed. But the zamindari repression could not subdue the resistance movement. The resisting tenants rather added a new slogan to their agenda: the total abolition of zamindari system. The slogan for reduction of rent rate was also raised by the peasants supporting the tebhaga struggle.

In some places the tebhaga movement made such an advance that the peasants declared their zone as tebhaga elaka and tebhaga committees were set up for the governance of the area locally. Under the tebhaga pressure many of the landholders withdrew their litigation filed against the tebhaga activists and came to terms with them. The tebhaga movement was most successful in the districts of Jessore, Dinajpur and Jalpaiguri. The tebhaga rights were extensively established in Midnapur and 24-Parganas. All these developments led the government to initiate a bill in the Legislative Assembly in early 1947. The bill intended to reform the barga system in the country in the light of the latest agrarian unrest. But other political developments handicapped the government to get the Barga Bill enacted into a law. The Partition of Bengal and the promises of the new government led to the suspension of the movement.

The tebhaga struggle was successful in so far as it has been estimated that about 40% of the sharecropping peasants got tebhaga right granted willingly by the landholders. The struggle also led to the abolition or reduction of unjust and illegal exaction in the name of ~~abwabs~~. But the movement had limited success in East Bengal districts. There was another spate of tebhaga movement in these districts in 1948-50. The government attributed the movement to the Indian agents, an allegation, which the general people tended to believe and thus refrained themselves from participating in the movement. But the movement had definitely influenced the passage of the east bengal state acquisition and tenancy act of 1950. [Sirajul Islam]



# DICTATORSHIP AND STRUGGLES FOR DEMOCRACY (1947-1971)

✓ By 1954, Awami League received huge support, especially from Bengal.

↳ One of the main reasons this happened was because of Sulhwanardy and Blasbani: main leaders of Awami League.

- |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• from aristocrat family</li> <li>• from West Bengal</li> <li>• parliament / politics experience</li> <li>• involved with mainstream politics of muslim league</li> <li>• educated class / upper class knew him well</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• from working class</li> <li>• his politics was more radicalized</li> <li>• did not do parliamentary politics</li> <li>• used to do movement</li> <li>• krishak/sramik writing</li> <li>• did a lot of farmer movement during British era against zamindars</li> </ul> |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

✓ Hence, people from all class supported Awami League.

✓ Quickly became popular in East Pakistan.

∴ unique combination

## # Election of 1954 + United Front

↳ In 1954, Pakistan government declared the first provincial election

↳ The United Front (Jukto Front) was formed in 1953 by a coalition of four parties with opposite

ideologies: Sulhwanardy → Blasbani

- Awami Muslim League
- Nezam-e-Islam

- Krishak Sramik Party
- Ganatantri Dal

→ A.K. Fazlul Haque

↳ The main reason for the formation of the United Front was to contest the 1954 elections against the ruling Muslim League.

↳ Since Muslim League was the dominant party that was becoming increasingly unresponsive to the people of East Pakistan, United Front promised to champion the rights of the Bengali people and to promote regional autonomy.

↳ The United Front's 21-point election manifesto included a number of demands that were seen as being essential for the advancement of East Pakistan, including:

- Recognition of Bengali as one of the state language of Pakistan
- Increased provincial autonomy
- Reform of the education system
- Protection of the rights of minorities

→ United Front contested against the Muslim League on 21-point demand

- recognition of Bengali as one of the state languages
- introduce free and universal primary education
- abolish zamindari system and distribute land to peasants
- economic and social rights of industrial workers
- nationalization of the jute industry
- protect country from flood and famine
- army HQ in W.P, navy HQ in E.P, ordinance factory in E.P

↳ The United Front's manifesto resonated with the people of East Pakistan and it won a landslide victory (228 out of 309) in the 1954 elections. [Muslim League only won 7 seats]

↳ The United Front's leader, A.K. Fazlul Haque was invited to form the government of East Pakistan

↳ After the election, Haque worked towards two goals: [chief minister of the province]

• Greater provincial autonomy for East Pakistan -

The United Front manifesto had called for a federal system with greater autonomy for the provinces. Haque believed that it was necessary to protect the interests of East Pakistan, which was economically and demographically larger of the two wings of Pakistan.

• Establishment of the Bangla Academy

The Bangla Academy is a cultural institution dedicated to the promotion of Bengali language and literature. Haque was a strong supporter of Bengali culture and he saw the establishment of Bangla Academy as a way to preserve and promote Bangla.

### LEADERS OF THE UNITED FRONT



A.K. Fazlul Haque



Moulana Abdul Hamid Khan Bhasani



Huseyn Shahood Suhrawardy

↳ Jukto Front government dismissed by Governor-General Ghulam Muhammad in a few months

reasons:  
• no ability to run  
• don't want Bengali in power  
West Pakistan



- \* Governor General:**
- British appointed role
  - sort of like President
  - top most in terms of power
  - represents British, but brown skin
  - one governor general given to each div.
  - he assesses the conditions of the partition are fulfilled or not, and if the country is moving properly or not.
- \* major retaliation, united front**  
reports they are not slaves of the central government

## CONSTITUTIONAL COUPS IN PAKISTAN

- 1953: Governor General Ghulam Muhammad dismisses Prime Minister Khawaja Nazimuddin for failure to control EP autonomy demands and imposes direct rule over EP
- October 1954: Ghulam Muhammad dissolves First Constituent Assembly
- July 1955: Second Constituent Assembly convened
- August 1955: Chaudhry Muhammad Ali becomes PM
- September 1955: General Iskander Mirza becomes Governor General
- March 1956: Constitution for Islamic Republic of Pakistan adopted
- September 1956: Suhrawardy becomes PM of Pakistan
- October 1957: Suhrawardy removed as PM
- October 7, 1958: Iskander Mirza imposes Martial Law
- October 27, 1958: General Ayub Khan removes Iskander Mirza
- March 1962: Ayub Khan introduces new constitution

in no assemblies were Bengalis given power

situation change: Iskander Mirza brought about some changes

• makes a new constitution in 1956

• suggested as Islamic Republic

• after the first time

• government will be parliamentary form

• strategic need: turned all sides of West Pakistan into one unit

• still Bengalis numerically greater

• provision because population greater here and thus less representation

East Pakistan → 150 members  
West Pakistan → 150 members  
300 members

## CONSTITUTION OF 1956

- 2 Second Constituent Assembly drafted and ratified the first constitution of Pakistan
- 2 Islamic republic
- 2 Parliamentary form of government
- 2 National parliament of 300 members, equally representing East and West Pakistan
- 2 Bengali recognized as one of the state languages
- 2 West Pakistan was integrated into one unit

debates/

- Conflicts start in Awami League based on two topics:

### ① Self-governance of East Pakistan:

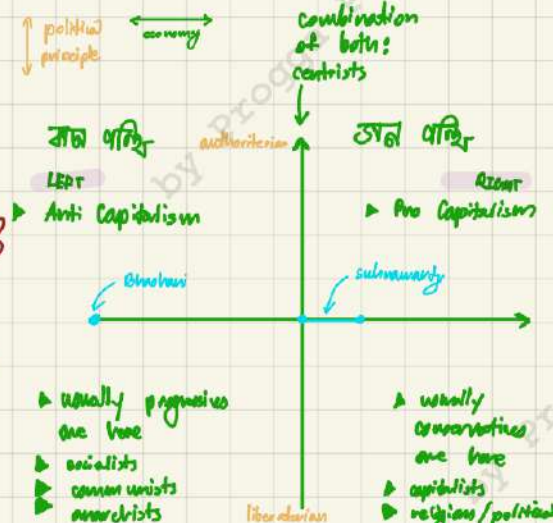
- ↳ Suhrawardy says since Awami League came into power, East Pakistan's 95% self-governance already achieved. So, no more movements needed in East Pakistan to demand self-governance.
- ↳ mostly students went against this; says he could bring any considerable or radical change to claim East Pakistan is self-governed. claimed to be unreasonable

### ② The issue of America:

- ↳ Because of cold war, geopolitically/strategically Pakistan was important
- ↳ Hence America often wanted to do deals with Pakis
- ↳ America wanted to do two military deals with Pakistan: SEATO, CENTO
  - ✓ Because of these deals, America can now keep military bases in Pakistan.
  - ✓ Similarly, there are a lot of American military bases all over the world.

- ↳ West Pakistan, Muslim League, military agreed to SEATO.
- ↳ Jinnah were against this: claimed to be problematic especially Bhakshuni
- ↳ Bhakshuni vs. Suhrawardy
- ↳ Jinnah's leader central target

- ↳ In order to come to a solution regarding this, Bhakshuni called a conference in 1957, known as Kaghar Conference
- ↳ It was a fair, folk songs, drama, games, even some Satyajit Ray's Potter Pablati
- ↳ Villagers thought it was for them



distinction: which political economy/economic mode one supports

entire world is dominated by Jinnah's party

- ✓ a very unique conference in Bangladesh
- ✓ Bhakshuni based upon an international cultural conference
- ✓ wanted to do it in the rural area of Kaghar, not Dhaka called Kaghar the capital of South Asia for those few days, not Dhaka, in order to include villagers in politics.



- ↳ It was actually a political conference, where Suhrawardy was present as well.
- ↳ Bhoshani talks about Secdo Centro.
- ↳ Also talked about West Pakistan's oppression
  - ✓ if West Pakistan continues to torture us / oppress us, we'll be forced to say "Walaikun - as - Salam"
  - ✓ That was the first indication of a separate Nation.
- ↳ No middle ground achieved in this conference.
- ↳ As a result, Bhoshani, and other JUI QF's left Awami League.

## \* Bhoshani and Insaafbad

- ↳ When Jukto Front came into power, Bhoshani was offered the position of the Prime Minister, but he declined.
- ↳ Subsequently, he left the United Front in 1957, citing a number of reasons:

• He was unhappy with the way United Front was being run and felt that the other leaders of the coalition were too willing to compromise with the Muslim League and that they were not doing enough to promote the interests of East Pakistan.

Bhoshani always wore a red cap - so LRA had attached a false tag on him, calling him Red Mawla and that he followed China's socialism theory.  
[रिड मवला - in favour of China]

• Bhoshani was increasingly drawn to his own ideology of socialism - insaafbad. He believed that the only way to achieve real progress was through a socialist revolution - which the United Front was not committed to.

• He was also unhappy with the way the United Front was handling the issue of Bengali nationalism and felt that the party was not doing enough to promote the idea of a separate Bengali state.

Many say Bhoshani left because Awami League took a secular stance, however, NAP did not have the word "Muslim" in its name either - so the theory might be wrong...

Bhoshani was a charismatic and independent leader who was unwilling to challenge the status quo

- ↳ In 1957, Bhoshani left to form his own party - National Awami Party (NAP).
- ↳ NAP was a more radical party than United Front and was committed to socialism and Bengali nationalism.
- ↳ Bhoshani remained the leader of NAP till his death in 1976.

- ↳ And this is how Awami League broke up.
- ↳ One of the most tragic events in the history of Bangladesh's politics

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- March 1962: Ayub Khan introduces new constitution

### THE AYUB ERA

- 1958: Martial Law, preemptive action to stop 1959 parliamentary elections and having majority Bengalis form government
- 1958 to 1962: Ayub ruled through Punjabi-dominated military and a pliant civil bureaucracy
- 1962: New Constitution with elections under "Basic Democracy"
- Basic Democracy: Indirect elections; President and Parliament elected through an Electoral College of 80,000 Basic Democrats

Patronage to Basic Democrats ensured Ayub Khan victory in elections in 1964-65

90,000 of his own people who will support him threat or otherwise

- Iskander Mirza claims Pakistan is no longer in the state of having a democratic government.
- No more viable political parties to run Pakistan
- Have decided let military look after the nation
- Military man was dictator
- Ayub Khan stopped all political activity, only innovation
- Gave himself a title without fulfilling any requirements
- Annulled all political figures.
- introduced basic democracy

### MILITARY DICTATORSHIP: OCTOBER 1958



Field Marshal (self-proclaimed) Mohammad Ayub Khan



## # Basic Democracy Order

- ↳ Having suspended the Constitution, Ayub set a new rule for the upcoming that will ensure only he gets to win.
- ↳ This was known as the Basic Democracy Order (BDO)
- ↳ This was a controlled form of democracy
- ↳ Where 40,000 people would be chosen from East Pakistan and another 40,000 from West Pakistan
- ↳ A total of these 80,000 locals (elected through 6 stages) will be eligible for voting for the President.
- ↳ But this was rigid because the people who were in charge of local selection received benefits from Ayub Khan and would only choose locals who were in favour of Khan.

## # Insaafbad vs. Socialism

[See British Rule, Pakistan and Bangladesh]

- ↳ Bhashani had seen it all - having born in 1880 - he had seen the initial partition of 1905, the 1947 India-Pakistan partition, the Great Bengal Famine, Language movements and Bangladesh's Liberation War.
- ↳ He was a man who started his political career with peasants - Krishak Andolon, unlike Fazlul Haque, who began his career advocating rights for peasants.
- ↳ Bhashani was known as the peasant leader turned political leader.
- ↳ He believed in insaafbad which ensured justice for all
- ↳ However, many leftist (communist) parties had tried to associate Bhashani with them because they merged the concept of socialism with insaafbad - and said that Bhashani simply used the Islamic term for socialism.

No country can stand on the basis of socialism. China is economically capitalist while following political socialism. North Korea has a dictatorship that rose from military socialism. Bangladesh wanted to ensure social justice - ~~not~~ <sup>not</sup> socialism.

Insaafbad, which was developed by Maulana Bhashani, is a Bengali word that means "justice." It is based on the principles of Islam and seeks to create a society where everyone is treated fairly and has equal opportunities. Insaafbad does not specifically advocate for the nationalization of industries or the abolition of private property, but it does believe that the government should play a role in regulating the economy and ensuring that the benefits of economic growth are shared by everyone.

Socialism, on the other hand, is a more radical ideology that advocates for the public ownership of the means of production. Socialists believe that private ownership of capital leads to exploitation and inequality, and they argue that the only way to achieve a just society is through the abolition of capitalism.

In practice, the two ideologies have often been combined. For example, many socialist countries have adopted some elements of Insaafbad, such as the government's role in providing social welfare programs. However, there are also some countries that have implemented Insaafbad without adopting socialism, such as Bangladesh.

Ultimately, the difference between Insaafbad and socialism is one of degree. Insaafbad is a more moderate ideology that seeks to achieve social justice through reforms within the existing system, while socialism is a more radical ideology that advocates for a complete overhaul of the economic system.



## # Political Instability

→ 1956

- ↳ The United Front government, with Fazlul Haque as its Chief Minister, collapsed 6 weeks after coming to power
- ↳ Because of Bihari-Bengali conflict / Urdu-Bangla conflict
- ↳ There were artificial riots instigated by Pakistan and CIA after 1954
- ↳ When the Jukto Front government was dismissed by Governor General Gulam Muhammad, it was due to the:
  - disagreements over the distribution of power
  - rise of Bengali nationalism
  - political maneuvering by the Pakistani government

appointed by Sir Khawaja Nazimuddin who became the prime minister after the assassination of Liaquat Ali Khan

## # Role of Gulam Muhammad

- ↳ Before 1951, he was the Finance Minister of Pakistan - in charge of overseeing the economic development of the country
- ↳ He was also a member of the Constituent Assembly of Pakistan who were responsible for drafting a constitution for the newly formed country.
- ↳ In 1953, Muhammad came back from the coronation of Elizabeth II to witness agitation spread in Dacca from the language movement and anti-Qadiyani protests in Lahore.
- ↳ This led him to use reserve powers awarded by the Government of India Act 1935 against Prime Minister Nazimuddin - effectively dismissing his administration.
- ↳ He also dissolves the First Constituent Assembly (who had tried to make legislative changes to the Act to check and balance a governor-general's power) and convened the Second Constituent Assembly.
- ↳ After the dismissal of Nazimuddin, Gulam assumed control of the government himself and was working towards two goals:
  - appoint a new Prime Minister (to establish a stable gov.) - Chaudhry Muhammad Ali
  - make a constitution for Pakistan
- ↳ However, Gulam Muhammad soon fell very sick and had to resign - giving up his post to General Iskander Mirza

• Bangla will be a state language with Urdu as the national language  
• Pakistan will be declared as an Islamic republic.



## \* Role of Iskander Mirza

- ↳ Between September '56 and October '57, Suhrawardy was the Prime Minister of Pakistan.
- ↳ Upon establishing the constitution in 1956, Mirza became the **President** from **Governor-General**. (first president)
- ↳ There was a lot of **political instability** during this time, since there had been a number of **changes in the government** leading up to 1958 and Pakistan was a young country with a weak political system.
- ↳ The **economic problems** and **regional tensions** were of course an issue.
- ↳ At the same time, the Pakistani military was becoming increasingly powerful and Mirza was concerned that it would intervene in politics if he did not take action.
- ↳ Mirza might also have been motivated by **personal ambition** to consolidate his power and stay in office.
- ↳ All these reasons led him to impose **Martial Law** on October 7, 1958 - where he suspends the constitution, dismisses the government of Sir Feroz Khan Noon and appoints his friend **General Ayub Khan** as the **chief martial law administrator** - who supported Mirza's decision as the commander-in-chief of the Pakistani Army

### CONSTITUTION OF 1956

- > Second Constituent Assembly drafted and ratified the first constitution of Pakistan
- > Islamic republic
- > Parliamentary form of government
- > National parliament of 300 members, equally representing East and West Pakistan
- > Bengali recognized as one of the state languages
- > West Pakistan was integrated into one unit

even though Mirza is not an army person and can't legally call for martial law

## \* Role of Ayub Khan

- ↳ But Khan was soon dissatisfied with Mirza's leadership and forced him to resign and exiled him to London.
- ↳ Khan himself became the President of Pakistan and continued the Martial law
- ↳ He was an intelligent who knew he needed to earn the trust of the public.
- ↳ So he targeted corruption. i.e. **price hiking**
- ↳ He also gave benefits and incentives to civil administration

His workers from DAF (Directorate General of Food) would raid markets in civilian districts and seize the offender as Government at night, render him by daylight in a state that left others to think twice before breaking the law

- ✓ Pakistani military in power, especially West Pakistan including Punjabis and Muhajirs
- ✓ America dependent, since they couldn't come out of SEATO CENTO

## \* One problem during Ayub Era:

Even though Ayub focused on development, he concentrated on **capitalist development**.

- ↳ One ideal example of such capitalist development is **S.M. Sharif Education Commission**.

problems:

wage/right of working class restricted

almost entirely dominated by the West Pakistan capitalist class

to encourage/grow/enrich capitalist system



# SM Sharif Education Commission:

- ↳ Since Ayub Khan was the civilian president, he aimed to correct the 1956 constitution which held no laws that would allow an election under BDO.
- ↳ So in 1962, the constitution was corrected into a new 'Amendment'
- ↳ After Ayub came into power, he had formed an education commission headed by education secretary SM Sharif so that he could easily impose Urdu on both wings
- ↳ In 1962, the EC finally published the SM Sharif Education policy that ended up deprioritising education for all.
- ↳ The recommendations made by the policy were:

even though 1956 constitution stated both Urdu and Bangla should be used

- > Urdu should be made the language of the people of Pakistan
- > English should be made compulsory from fourth grade
- > No free primary education
- > Education not to be subsidized

subsidy, a direct or indirect payment, - economic concession, or privilege granted by a government to private firms, households, or other governmental units in order to promote a public objective.

→ Ayub liked him  
→ commonly known as the Sharif commission

✓ Problems:

- ↳ West Pakistan was okay with the policy because they had more money to study with their own income.
- ↳ East Pakistan <sup>majority</sup> had a low income (can't spend enough money on education) so literacy rate goes down so they can be easily dominated.
- ↳ Bengalis were predominantly targeted.

↳ lower class / middle class frequency higher in East Pakistan

✓ Outcome:

- ↳ University students start protest against this.
- ↳ Multiple student protests rose against the Education Commission (against all points except English)
- ↳ 3 students killed in the protest and so Ayub postponed the recommendations of the Sharif Commission.

ফার্মাট ১৯:৪০৫৬১ গীতি

→ centralized around DU  
→ led: EJS Union, EJS League

↳ I was a Tongi worker coincidentally

# 1965 disastrous war: (Kashmir)

- ↳ In 1965, Ayub Khan was misguided by his advisors (his close people) and launched an air attack on Kashmir to make India weak.
- ↳ This resulted in the Indo-Pak war (lasted for 17 days) • both claimed to win • India actually had upper hand / advantage
- ↳ Consequently, Tashkent Declaration was signed which agreed to cease fire
- ↳ In the meantime, a dilemma rose in East Pakistan:
  - During the war, (soldiers, ammunition) were taken from East Pakistan Rifles, East Bengal Regiment → all protection / security was taken from the East to the Indo Pak border and East Pakistan was left defenceless
- ↳ India couldn't easily take over East Pakistan in this time but it was removed this did not happen because there was a good relation between Bangabandhu and Indira Gandhi
- ↳ As a result a political vacuum was created: Suhrawardy dead, water / power underground
- ↳ So in 1966, there was a meeting of the opposition party members in Lahore [because of the discrimination faced by East Pakistan throughout 1947-1965]
- ↳ Bangabandhu raised his voice and announced the 6 point programme
  - which demanded economic emancipation [অর্থনৈতিক অর্থ মুক্তি সনদ] due to our economic insecurities.
  - contained all the components of an independent nation

↳ alienated economic exploitation



## # 6 points demand:

✓ based on Lahore Resolution

### THE AYUB ERA: 6 POINT DEMAND

The Six Point demands were:

1. Creating provision in the constitution for a Federation of Pakistan in its true sense based on the Lahore resolution
2. The federal government will deal with only two subjects: Defense and Foreign Affairs
3. Introduction of two separate, but freely convertible currencies for East and West Pakistan
4. Vesting the power of taxation and revenue collection with the federating units
5. Maintaining two separate accounts for the foreign exchange earnings of the two wings and
6. Creation of a separate militia or paramilitary force for East Pakistan

- East Pakistan everyone accepted this.
- Went into a nation-wide movement scale.
- Hence this movement is called movement for freedom/independence
- Started as a self-sufficiency demand

#### Six Points

1. The Constitution should provide for a Federation of Pakistan in its true sense on the Lahore Resolution, and the parliamentary form of government with supremacy of a Legislature directly elected on the basis of universal adult franchise.
2. The federal government should deal with only two subjects: Defence and Foreign Affairs, and all other residuary subjects shall be vested in the federating states.
3. Two separate, but freely convertible currencies for two wings should be introduced; or if this is not feasible, there should be one currency for the whole country, but effective constitutional provisions should be introduced to stop the flight of capital from East to West Pakistan. Furthermore, a separate Banking Reserve should be established, and separate fiscal and monetary policy be adopted for East Pakistan.
4. The power of taxation and revenue collection shall be vested in the federating units and the federal centre will have no such power on the issue. The federation will be entitled to a share in the state taxes to meet its expenditures.
5. There should be two separate accounts for the foreign exchange earnings of the two wings; the foreign exchange requirements of the federal government should be met by the two wings equally or in a ratio to be fixed; indigenous products should move free of duty between the two wings, and the Constitution should empower the units to establish trade links with foreign countries.
6. East Pakistan should have a separate militia or paramilitary force.



# THE WAR OF INDEPENDENCE

- ↳ Big shot politicians feared the death penalty of rastrodroho if they supported the 6 point demand
- ↳ So when Bangabandhu went ahead and asked everyone in a meeting at 32 Dharmadi to accept the demand, everyone ran from the meeting room. But they couldn't leave the house because of security. Bangabandhu's right hand, Serajul Alam Khan (who later became JSD leader because of political differences) was standing in front of the gate with a "lathi" to beat the shit out of those who would attempt to run. Khan would catch the escapees and force them to sign.

↳ Meanwhile, in the West, Bhutto was the foreign minister of Ayub and the founder of PPP.

↳ When Bangabandhu presented the 6 point movement, Bhutto resigned the foreign ministry and used students to rebel against Ayub in 1966.

↳ This resulted in Ayub being under a lot of pressure, so he arrested Bhutto and sent him to jail for 6 months.

↳ In 1968, the Agartala conspiracy case was also filed which was a rastrodroho mamla → State vs Mujib and others (34 military/civilian/politicians accused)

↳ The case claimed that these people met with Indira Gandhi's representatives and legislative officers to conspire against the unity of Pakistan.

↳ The accused supposedly discussed the role India would play if EP fought for its independence.  
(logistical, economical or artillery support?)

↳ Ayub Khan did not arrest only one man due to geopolitical advantage: Mawlana Bhashani

- ✓ Because of China
- ✓ Mao-Tse Tung ← JSD officer (leftist)
- ✓ China imminent communist revolution
- ✓ Bhashani and Bhashani - JSD supporters had good relationship with Mao officers
  - ✓ not directly Maoist
  - ✓ more aligned to China - officers / Mao officers than Moscow
- ✓ Hence Bhashani and Mao Tse Tung had a very good relationship
- ✓ Went to China two times for meetings

↳ Even though ideologically dissimilar, Ayub needed China. This is because China had beef with India. Tried to form a good relationship between China and Pakistan.

↳ And hence did not arrest Bhashani: Ayub's biggest mistake.

↳ Sheikh Mujib's mentor was Suhrawardy & Bhashani

↳ Ayub didn't care much about this

After the independence of EP, General Ziaul Khan (Army chief) arranged for a military coup and arrested Bhutto. He was continuously injected with sleeping pills that made him restless. One day, Ziaul Khan randomly ordered Bhutto to be hanged and yet pushed high power sleeping pills in his veins the night before. He couldn't stay upright and so was crucified with ropes to be hanged. Family called to show dead body which was later buried at a secret location by the government in hopes that the family does not create any political unrest with the dead body. This Ziaul Khan also died in a plane crash and his body was not found.

why  
Ayub  
did not  
arrest  
Bhashani



- ↳ Sheikh Mujib secretly sent Bhakuni a messages
  - They're conspiring to had me in
  - If we don't start a movement I will be lagged.

(Bhakuni vs Goudhi)

- ↳ Bhakuni brought Awami League and NAP together and directly demanded in protests.

✓ Bhakuni nowhere to be found: moving rapidly from place to place doing movements

- ↳ At that time, Chhatro Union and Chhatro League (formed by Mujib)

new holds major positions in AL

more powerful and influential than ... and violently against

rebelling against Agartala Case

"Bangabandhu" title given

- ↳ In 1969, Chhatro League made placards (Sheikh Mujib er mukti chor) and Chhatro Union changed that to Sheikh Mujibur Rahman along shakel rajbandi der mukti shak
- ↳ and rose in a mass upsurge where many students died.

"jail er baba bangbo Sheikh Mujib ke anbo"

- ↳ Impact of Mass upsurge:

✓ violent since the beginning  
✓ directly threatened Ayub  
✓ started as a movement to free Mujib  
✓ turned into anti-Ayub movement

✓ Not only AL or NAP, but all towns from East and West joined

✓ Jami-e-Islam also became a part: everyone was confused

✓ spontaneous movement

✓ ~~STARS~~ joined in.

- Agartala Case cancelled
- Bangabandhu was released from jail
- Ayub Khan resigned → good thing for Pakistan

- ↳ After the fall of Ayub Khan of 1969, Mujib was named 'Bangabandhu'.

- ↳ Yahya Khan was now the new President under Martial Law

✓ first time Oboroth used as a strategy

- ↳ Then he home arrested Ayub Khan

- ↳ Yahya Khan was a totally non political person with no ambition to stay in power

- ↳ He even declared "I won't be a long term president. I will declare a national election and hand over power."

- ↳ In the meanwhile, Bhutto's sly nature allowed him to be very influential and was determined to have a good relation with Yahya Khan so that he could have manipulation abilities on the election.

Hakuni sir / 1971 video box

- ↳ Military Secretary / Advisor was a good friend of Bhutto

- ↳ Advisors gave advice to Martial Law Administrator since they don't have a lot of public support

- ↳ Bhutto was externally influenced Yahya through military secretary

eg. Yahya had to read scripts edited by Bhutto

eg. Bhutto told MLA to not go to Dhaka, that matters have been resolved; when it wasn't; even though both Bhutto and Mujib were waiting for him.

- ↳ To aid the 70's election, Yahya Khan declared Legal Framework Order or the LFO, with two main conditions:

① the person who contests for Prime Minister must be Muslim

② no political parties can hand election manifestos that are against the ideologies of Pakistan.

- ↳ This might be because Yahya Khan was afraid that Mujib would ask for independence through the election as he was afraid of election postponement (which would be detrimental for EP)

⑤ After the election, Mujib and Bhutto took a walk in the gardens of Gonolabon. Bhutto had proposed that "I can be PM while you can be president to Mujib. Mujib questioned that since Bhutto didn't win the majority of seats, why should he be the PM? When Mujib left Bhutto in his car, he saw the resolve in Mujib's eyes for EP's independence. That's how he decided that it was time for Operation Searchlight.

⑤ After the War of Independence, both political leaders had to be civil to each other, to a point that Bhutto begged for Mujib to be allowed to join the OIC (for the sake of diplomacy)

↳ only conference were all the muslim leaders who participated were assassinated

⑤ Bhutto also ordered the killing of intellectuals on 14th December. However, Mujib still received Bhutto after Independence. Bhutto landed and went straight to Britishoukha to give flowers to the people he killed.



## THE YAHYA INTERREGNUM

- 1970 national elections: first ever in undivided Pakistan on the basis of universal adult franchise
- Awami League wins 160 out of 162 seats in EP; majority party in 300 seat national assembly with right to form government
- November 1970: cyclone hits coastal EP killing 500,000; Pakistan government fails to intervene in relief efforts
- Bengalees realize even more the exploitative nature of the Pakistan state and their indifference to the interests of EP
- March 1: Yahya postpones convening of National Assembly

Pakistan loses legitimacy in EP; spontaneous demonstrations all over the country;

- ✓ Yahya Khan diverted the topic of the then current ongoing affairs and distracted people with the election of 1971.
- ✓ For the first time election occurring in the whole of Pakistan on a national level.

Two things happened in 1970:

- Election
- Bhola cyclone → no one was warned beforehand  
→ thousands of people died  
→ more lost and never found  
→ negligence seen from government
- Yahya's government found not prioritizing people as well
- Bengali took this ignorance to heart

- Bhushani was the first to reach out to examine the damage.
- Later in a speech he said "গত ১৯৭০ সালের নির্বাচন" which was printed in newspapers
- Before election Bhushani concluded "They do not care about us." ✓ and boycotted the election
- All leftists concluded the same. "They did not prioritize us." in 1970  
"From now on NAP and my goal is independence / independent East Pakistan."
- Awami League participated in the election

So, why did Awami League not boycott the election? Why did they continue?

- Ans:
- Main opposition of Awami League was NAP.
  - Since there is no more NAP, they are bound to win
  - No significant opposites
  - It is said it was both NAP & Awami League's plan to have all votes to Awami League.
  - Political strategy to make sure one party will push revolutionary motives, while other will prove a point that we follow constitution and democracy
  - Attract from both sides.

Awami League was in the national election as well, getting votes from West Pakistan since NAP supports them, too.  
✓ Landslide victory

## 1970 ELECTION AND LANDSLIDE VICTORY

- Bangabandhu led Awami League won a landslide victory on the basis of the six point demand
- 160 out of 162 seats in EP; total seats in Pakistan - 300
- Bhutto's PPP won 81 seats; all in WP
- Absolute victory of Awami League energized EP demand for freedom and regional autonomy



- People's Party protesting that Awami League's votes weren't legitimate / protested against Prime Minister
- Yahya Khan's military regime keeps on asking more time before they handover power
- This led to 7th March and 25th March incident

## POST-ELECTION EVENTS

- Bhutto refuses to allow Mujib to form government
- January 17, 1971: Yahya visits Bhutto in Larkana with military generals and draws up plan for military action in EP
- Pak military in EP strengthened and prepared for Operation Blitz
- March 1: Yahya postpones convening of Parliament
- Bengalis realize Pakistan cannot be trusted to hand over power
- Non Cooperation Movement starts
- March 2: Students hoist flag of BD at Dhaka University
- March 3: Students read out Manifesto of BD Independence
- March 7: Mujib calls on people to resist conspiracies and prepare for struggle for freedom and independence
- March: Yahya and Bhutto hold meetings with Mujib and AL but secretly prepare for genocide
- March 25: Operation Searchlight and mass killings start under General Khadim Hussain Raja
- March 26: Bangabandhu declares independence of Bangladesh

## OPERATION SEARCHLIGHT: MILITARY CRACKDOWN

- In Dhaka targeted attacks with tanks and artillery on
- student halls
  - university teachers
  - HQ of Police and East Pakistan Rifles
  - Hindu residential areas
  - urban slums



② The other seats won by EP were by 5 PM leaders and 3 tribal leaders named Matabandras Khayyum Larina

➢ recently all his belongings and property was damaged because people thought he was anti-Bangladesh - but he just wanted the billy benches to be a separate state.

- ↳ After Mujib won the election, Yahya openly congratulated him and promised that on 1st March, Mujib would take oath in the National Assembly in front of the whole of Pakistan.
- ↳ Some people were already convinced that Bhutto would start a military operation since there were "anti-state" movements by Awami League and Chhatra League.
- ↳ When Mujib almost declared independence on 3rd/7th March, Bhutto felt like he had no alternative to show power by any means except genocide.
- ↳ Operation Blitz was planned → but the plan was leaked and hence, cancelled.
- ↳ The same plans were renamed to Operation Searchlight as a political brainchild to carry out mass genocide.



- ↳ Governor Ahsan was from East Pakistan but he was empathetic towards East Pakistan.
- ↳ he denied allowing Operation Searchlight to be carried out when the plan was shared with him.
- ↳ Another governor, Shahabuddin Yaqub Khan was also not in favour of Operation Searchlight since he was in good terms with GP.
- ↳ he too was removed, just after 15 days.
- ↳ General Tikka Khan (aka Butcher of Balochistan) was now named the governor of EP who opted to form an exile government too.
- ↳ And so he allowed the postponement of the 1st March National Assembly / Parliament to 25th March
- ↳ Mujib being the charismatic leader noticed that a lot of arms were incoming into the Chittagong port
- ↳ Major Ziaur Rahman being stationed there, went to investigate
- ↳ He ultimately went against Pak army → because EP people did not want to get the arms down from the WP containers and so they were directly fired upon, Zia tried to control that.
- ↳ Mujib did not flee when though he knew he would be arrested.
- ↳ He urged Tajuddin Ahmed to cross the border and seek help from Indira Gandhi.
- ↳ Mujib had also recorded the declaration of independence before he was arrested.
- ↳ Zia was given Birprotik later on by Mujib
- ↳ Major Rodrigue (senior at Chittagong Cantonment) → was put in house arrest, along with a lot of other military personnel without their arms.
- ↳ Pak army was the 4th strongest in the world and it was difficult to fight against them.
- ↳ To inspire them, Mujib decided to ask a Bengali army officer to read off from the declaration of independence.
- ↳ Major Rodrigue was first asked but he denied for the sake of other officers' (in house arrest) safety
- ↳ So the second senior officer, Major Ziaur Rahman, was sent to Dhaka
- ↳ He read the declaration on behalf of Mujib but he first forgot to mention it (he later specified)  
He never claimed to have called independence himself.

③ This very Zia is now to have thought to be involved in the killing of Mujib. So he arranged a military coup as Deputy General. Taker was in control of the army but Zia had the popularity. So when Taker called out for the "19 dafa dabo", Zia only read the parts that he liked and consequently declared Martial Law and became Martial Law Administrator. [Zia didn't want to leave the safety and power of cantonment after Taker had released him from jail. So he urged Taker to come to Cantonment where it was game over for Taker's demands] → Sunder of Jashod → Biplobi gonobahini

④ After Zia became CMIA, he declared a formal law that if someone does anything against the state then they will be arrested and served maximum punishment. Zia ended up removing Taker, arresting under court trial and putting him through "camera trial". Taker was limp when he was hanged at 8am. Zia delayed and signed the mercy petition at 8am which he himself had asked Taker's wife to give last night.

↳ After 26th March, an exile gov. was formed (Mujib namok earlier)

President: Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman

Vice President / Acting President: Syed Nazrul Islam

Prime Minister: Tajuddin Ahmed.

- ↳ this gov. was legalized on 10th April and they took oath on 17th April
- ↳ Indira Gandhi's advisors told her to give this gov. logistical support to aid the aim of Bangladesh.

#### GOVERNMENT-IN-EXILE



- Formed on April 10, 1971
- Took oath on April 17, 1971 at Mujibnagar, Meherpur, Kushtia
- Mujib declared president of BD
- Acting President - Syed Nazrul Islam
- Prime Minister - Tajuddin Ahmed
- Commander of BD Mukti Bahini - Colonel M A G Osmani
- A small cabinet was also formed





Q. Why were some places specifically attacked on 25th March night? What justification did the military give?

Ans: They were killing professors and intellectuals and that was obvious. However an official justification army claimed India had invaded and were planning to drive Pakistanis away/ trying to separate. The army was waiting for Bangabandhu to announce independence on 7th March. How was India planning to separate? They claimed:

- via Awami League note → they were first arrested

- via students → halls were attacked

- via Hindus → claimed they were actually killing Indian agents

main reason: ✓ even before 7th March spread Rumour that taken taking preparations for a war  
✓ halls were storage for arms  
✓ students were preparing for the war  
✓ they didn't realize military would arrive so fast  
✓ military intelligence supplied them with these info made

↳ high rank military person, so it was good for all military personnel

Q. Ziaur Rahman announced independence of Bangladesh two times. Why?

Ans: ✓ The first time he didn't mention Bangabandhu. Sheikh Mujibur Rahman.

✓ People told him no one knows you except military people/ not popular enough  
general people don't know you.

✓ Make sure people know it's Bangabandhu.

✓ In the next announcement he cited citation Bangabandhu.

### DECLARATION OF INDEPENDENCE

- March 26, 1971: Before his arrest, Bangabandhu declared independence of Bangladesh transmitted through EPR wireless  
*"This may be my last message. From today Bangla Desh is independent. I call upon the people of Bangla Desh, wherever you are and with whatever you have, to resist the army of occupation to the last. Your fight must go on until the last soldier of the Pakistan occupation army is expelled from the soil of Bangla Desh and final victory is achieved."*
- March 26, 2:30 PM: AL Leader M A Hannan broadcasts message from Chittagong Radio
- March 26 and 27: broadcasts from Kalurghat radio station by Swadhin Bangla Betar Kendra
- March 27, 7:30 PM: Major Zia announces independence and military revolt from Kalurghat radio station

Zia's announcement (on Bangabandhu's behalf) was heard by many more than earlier announcements and had a strong impact

• We see freedom fighters with having:

- ✓ same training
- ✓ same ideology (political)
- ✓ same intentions

• in reality that wasn't the case

- small number of fighters in many places
- their background / ideology were different: ✓ Krishak ✓ student

↳ they were directly helped / trained by India

### MUKTI BAHINI AND ARMED STRUGGLE

- Mukti Bahini also known as freedom fighters
- Mujibnagar Government formed Mukti Bahini under the command of Colonel M A G Osmani
- War strategy mainly was guerilla warfare
- Regular and irregular forces were formed
- The country was divided into eleven sectors ✓



↳ officially the largest Mukti Fajj

↳ operation designed by military

• many did not go to India for training ✓ job holder

• some were loyal towards Bangabandhu but not Awami League.

• some were loyal towards Awami League but sceptical towards India.



- ↳ Gov. in exile gave Colonel Osmani the responsibility to make a liberation war strategy
- ↳ He had a meeting with Bengali ex Pak Army members in Sylhet, Teliapora <sup>→ later renamed as sector 3 till May</sup>
- ↳ And divided Bengal into 11 sectors <sup>→ first 2 out of 3 policy making meetings of the Mukti Bahini was held here</sup>
  - each with its own sector / sub sector commanders.
  - the last sector was naval and had no commanders.

↳ 3 forces were made with 3 commanders to coordinate the Mukti Bahini

- **S Force** - KM Saffiullah
- **K Force** - Khaled Mosharraf
- **Z Force** - Ziaur Rahman

- Other forces:
  - ✓ Mujib Bahini
  - ✓ Kader Bahini
  - ✓ Some other leftist forces
- Brigade forces:
  - ✓ Z force- Ziaur Rahman
  - ✓ K force- Khaled Mosharraf
  - ✓ S force- K.M. Saffiullah
- Naval and air wings
- Crack platoon of Mukti Bahini was very active in occupied Dhaka and kept people's morale high

↳ But how will untrained E.F. fight against Pak's 4th strongest army in the world.

- "hit and run" strategy was decided
- crisis: impossible to hide in plain land and run away without vehicles; it was only possible in hilly tracts. yet freedom fighters were losing lives to natural causes like snake bites
- "face-to-face" fighting strategy implemented

↳ So how will the recruitment be done?

- It was first decided that members of **AL + CL + CW** are supposed to go to war
- But politically elected fighters do not show nationalism
- and people not involved in the party wanted to fight in the war too
- this created a crisis since these people needed the party's approval to go to India for training, so AL took all of them in.

↳ Romantic guerilla

- 18-20 year olds who are desperate to go to war
- AL did not want to allow them because of their own age
- So they would plan themselves and attack Pak Army
- This disrupted the plans of the actual Mukti Bahini
- Eventually, some of them were selected for the Mukti Bahini and sent to India for training.

③ India housed 10 million refugees and sent most back due to economic crisis

③ Anti:- mukti bahini → rajshakar + al border  
→ bihari  
- a lot of people were forced → give money from people or be rajshakar

26,000 bihari killed after independence and land/property seized by gov.

↳ Around November, Chatro League / Joba League leaders emerged with their 4 leaders:

- Tohayer Ahmed
- Sirazul Alam Khan
- Abdul Rozzak
- Sheikh Fazlul Haque Monin

↳ They created the **Mujib Bahini**

↳ and propagated that they were close to Bangabandhu and proposed the 4 ideals of Mujibism which are **nationalism, secularism, socialism and democracy** (4 pillars of the constitution and Mujibism)

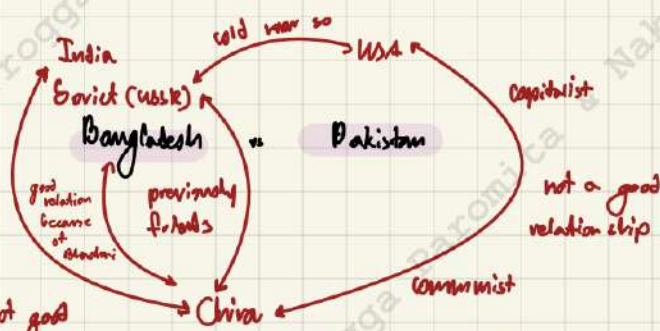
↳ But the Mujib nagar sarkar was against Mujibism, so Mujib bahini ended up having a clash with Mujibnagar

↳ The Mujib Bahini influenced Indira Gandhi to open a separate training centre in Dehradun, India and train separate commanders with separate walkie talkie system.

↳ On December 3, Yahya was wrongly influenced / brainwashed, and so he launched Indo-Pak War



## # Geopolitical condition:



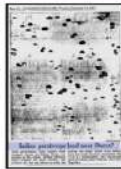
## # Role of superpowers:

- Maoists confused as they supported Pakistan.
- All groups participated in the war except one.
- 1971 was actually just a proxy war between USSR and USA. From an international / geopolitical perspective.
- Soviet helped us through India, not directly.
- USA directly supplied weapons to Pakistan.
- USA government supported Pakistan thoroughly and from day 1.
- Nixon ignored the ongoing massacre.
- However people did not support and they even held anti protests.
- George Harrison, Ravi Shankar did fund raising concert.
- 1 crore people took refuge in India.
- Churnal people accepted us and helped us; we had to acknowledge that.

- India only joined in and helped Bangladesh with Mitrabahini when Pakistan attacked their air base.
- Another reason is it was monsoon season and maneuvering military was difficult, hence the delay.

**THE 14 DAY INDO-PAK WAR: DECEMBER 3-16**

- Yahya Khan instructed the army to attack on western part of India. But it failed to distract India from East Pakistan.
- As a result, India-Pakistan war broke out.
- In December, Pakistani soldiers were already in total disaster caused by the Mukti Bahini attacks.
- Mukti Bahini gave all information about the ground and the strategic enemy lines.




- India launched cross border operation on December 4, 1971 to expel Pakistani army from East Pakistan.
- Thousands of Indian troops with support of navy and air force set their foot on Bangladeshi soil.

**GLOBAL SUPPORT FOR BANGLADESH**

- Local media couldn't cover the liberation war stories and Pakistani atrocities.
- International media wholeheartedly stood beside the oppressed people of Bangladesh.
- Concern for Bangladesh was organized and drew huge global attention.



- A French activist hijacked a Pakistani aid/relief plane and demanded there to be taken to Bangladesh due to their crisis.
- Ultimately he was arrested by it spread awareness internationally and later France sent relief.
- West: through journalism, activism

**THE SURRENDER OF THE PAKISTANI FORCES**




Lieutenant General Niazi being escorted by Lieutenant General Aurora and Major ATM Halder for the signing of the Instrument of Surrender on 16 December 1971.

Lieutenant General Niazi signing the Instrument of Surrender.

- Rape was used as a weapon to induce fear and panic; thousands of women gang raped and tortured for days on end in order to leave behind what they claim as "শ্রীমতী গণহত্যা" in order to spread their bloodline.
- Intellectuals and industrialists were killed when they realized their imminent defeat.

↑ huge loss

- ② Mujibnagar Sarkar wanted to come but they could have been killed at the signing, so they didn't.
- ② Why did Osmani not come to the instrument of surrender of the Pak army?
  - Because the Pak army wanted to do one last massive killing and they must finish fast
  - An helicopter was sent but later formed technical issues
  - an official from gov (Bangladesh/Pak) would challenge it

- ② Geneva convention
  - ↳ release 93000 war prisoners from both sides
  - ↳ rank protocol
  - ↳ Colonel can't sign; so general must



# EARLY DAYS AND CHALLENGES

- ↳ 8th Jan, 1972 → Mujib was released from jail
- ↳ first went to London to meet an international journalist
- ↳ then went to India / Gandhi to express his gratitude for her contribution
- ↳ he did not know Bangladesh had become independent when he was in jail
- ↳ instead went to jail multiple times to say he should be President while Mujib becomes PM
- ↳ Dr Kamal Hossain (Legal advisor) informed Mujib that Bangladesh was now independent

## # Measurable Damages:

- Destroyed infrastructures: bridges, roads, transportations
  - Halted farm work:   
 resulting in a problem of food production
- ↳ some were destroyed by Mukti Bahini so that Pakistanis cannot invade / transcross  
e.g. Hardinge Bridge

### CHALLENGES OF NATION BUILDING

- Agriculture sector was severely affected with immediate and substantial decline in production of rice, jute and tea
- The physical infrastructure of the country was in ruins with ports and major bridges out of operations
- In the industrial sector, the value of assets destroyed was estimated to be in millions of taka
- Non-measurable consequences of the war, caused by the loss of raw materials and spare parts, lack of maintenance, transfer of monetary assets, departure of a number of top managers and skilled workers, and market disruptions were immense

- post-war country wasn't no law and order existed
- no organised police force
- no lawyers
- this was used as an opportunity to take over land and house

### CHALLENGES OF NATION BUILDING

- An overall estimate of the 1971 war might perhaps be nearer US\$ 2 billion
- A World Bank report identified the challenges faced by independent Bangladesh:
- First, all 10 million refugees had to be returned and resettled, with appropriate relief to get them through until the first harvest
- Secondly, law and order had to be re-established – the situation aggravated by the ample supply of weapons left over from the war period

### problem:

- trauma nature different
- some lost everything, so no reason to return
- some returned only to find out their house had been ransacked, looted or taken over by new owners
- Most of Hindu property was taken over by Bengalis under "enemy property"
- Hindus were predominantly targeted.

### CHALLENGES OF NATION BUILDING

- Thirdly, adequate supplies of food had to be obtained and distributed through the damaged transport system, to avert the threat of famine
- Fourthly, the political and administrative structure had to be reconstituted and new institutions created to fill the gap left by the former Central government
- Fifthly, the task of reconstruction had to be commenced and the economy restored to the pre-1971 level as quickly as possible

- how will the parliament run?
- no constitution yet
- what rules will stay or what will be introduced?
- what will be the political goal?

### BANGABANDHU'S ACHIEVEMENTS

- Despite the severe hardships which Bangabandhu's administration faced, the record of achievements was significant
- Nearly all refugees were resettled and a famine averted
- In 1972 there was some shortfall in agricultural production, due primarily to drought but 2.27 million tons of rice crop was harvested
- Industrial production made a fast recovery
- Chittagong port was cleared and all damaged big bridges, with the exception of one, were repaired
- Foreign exports were pushed up

### BANGABANDHU'S ACHIEVEMENTS

- On 17 January Bangabandhu called for the surrender of arms by the Mukti Bahini within a ten-day time limit
- He reiterated his earlier belief that power does not come from the barrel of the gun but rather stems from the people
- On 24 January he went to Tangail to preside over the ceremony of surrender of arms by Kader Siddiqui (nicknamed Tiger) and his men
- In the next few days other groups of the Mukti Bahini surrendered their arms

### BANGABANDHU'S ACHIEVEMENTS

- Parallel to this, efforts were made to strengthen the different disciplinary forces like Police, BDR and Armed Forces
- Bengali soldiers replaced Indian soldiers and took up responsibility of ensuring national security
- Upon Bangabandhu's discussion with Indian Prime Minister Indira Gandhi, all Indian troops were withdrawn from Bangladesh by March 1972
- Civil administration was also slowly reinstated
- Within two months district officers were appointed in all the districts and a decision was taken to upgrade the subdivisions into district

✓ One problem which arised post war was the was availability / ownership of weapons / firearms:

- during this time food was in short supply
- so hunger led to people using these weapons to forcefully obtain / steal food resulting in violence
- ideology doesn't matter during hunger.
- other political parties may rise

taken with great importance

- one of the first things he did after returning
- done on a grand scale

"এসে জাতি স্বেচ্ছায় সশস্ত্র হওয়া উচিত" arised at that time meaning training cannot be cleared.

• 31<sup>st</sup> January Dhaka Stadium

matter of concern:

- occurred they might conquer us
- occurred they looted us too



## # Bangabandhu faced with many challenges:

### ① Needed to form a constitution for Bangladesh

→ made a 34 member committee, with Dr. Kamal Hossain as the leader; all members are from AL and one was from opposition (NAD) → Suranjit Sen Gupta

### ② Forming a legitimate government

→ Mujib was made president on the basis of Mujibnagar Sarkar because the election was not done yet

### ③ Conducting an election

→ Successfully overcame on March 1973, Slogan: *ek neta ek desh, sheikh mujib bangladesh*

→ Jashed (jatiyo somaj tantrik dal) from AL leaders detachment

"*Ek torfa*" election, AL won the most seats

### Crisis: Would Mujib be the President or the PM?

→ The legal advisor had claimed that since we had fought for democracy, so we should form a parliamentary form of government; no a presidential one (where he doesn't need to attend the parliament, cap. send a PM as representative)

→ Here the PM would be the executive head for a stronger form of democracy

→ The election would elect Mujib as the PM and he would ensure more accountability

### ④ Withdrawal of the Indian Army from Bangladesh

→ the Indian army had started to interfere in politics and policy making

→ So Mujib asked Gandhi to withdraw her army which she did in 3 months (as a birthday gift to him)

### ⑤ Had to tackle JSD (created by AL and CL leaders)

→ created by Sirajul Alam Khan (part of Mujib Bahini) and they believed in somajtontro

→ both leaders believed in socialism: social justice (Mujib) + scientific socialism (JSD)

→ *social justice*: was not feasible, Mujib knew that.

→ *scientific socialism*: do something that must benefit the state in some way eg. everyone must do industry/agriculture

↳ this has been experimented in Cambodia and ended with 3-6 lakh people dead

→ JSD had an ideological clash with Bangabandhu

→ Another was the fact that they did not want any rank in the army (which was actually implemented through Zia after Mujib's death).

### ⑥ How to tackle the sorbohara party

→ did a lot of robbery, kidnapping, arson, empty firing

→ believed that 50% of the possession of rich people belongs to poor people

→ the party was led by Siraj Sikder who was later arrested and given two options

• leave sorbohara party and join AL

• leave politics completely

→ recruited intellectuals from DU/BUET

Crisis: A plan was made for a grihojuddho → JSD + Indian Arms + AL. India could easily interfere with Bangladeshi affairs. Mujib kept a respectful, fine gap with India as a consequence (never wanted India hostokhep)

Crisis: Jatiyo Rakshi Bahini → Civilians who participated in the war were given high posts compared to trained military personnel with years of training. Mujib prioritised freedom fighters and brought them uniforms and rifles from India.



crisis: Refugee crisis - Mujib immediately brought back refugees home after the refugee andolan broke out in India. In 1974, there was a man-made famine and America had blacklisted all socialist countries. The relief that was supposed to be sent to BD was stopped by Nixon and sent to Cuba as a gift and so the famine was created from a gap in rice relief. People had moved to the cities and refused to go back to the villages.

challenges: Political crisis of getting international recognition. Middle East countries were confused on what Mujib's ideology would be after detaching from an Islamic country and create a constitution based on secularism.

These countries gave Bangladesh a few conditions:

- must give Pakistan her recognition
- must release the war criminals (jamaat shibir had connections with the Middle East)

If Mujib had chosen the emotional response, he would not have fulfilled the conditions and so the people would die. So Mujib chose reality and hoped to bring justice later after initially releasing them. And so Bangladesh got the recognition and relief from Middle East.

→ There was socio-political improvement too through a governor system where local leaders will be selected as governors but they all fled after Mujib's death in 1975.



magnified as a sovereign, independent country

## BANGLADESH AND THE WORLD

- Within a year of its independence, Bangladesh had been recognized by 97 countries, and had become a member of several international bodies - WHO, UNESCO, World Bank, and IMF
- Though it was denied membership in the U.N., the country's existence as a sovereign entity was recognized as an unchallengeable reality
- Bangabandhu's steadfast commitment to the Palestinian cause and Bangladesh's prompt assistance to Egypt and Syria during the 1973 Arab-Israeli war ensured diplomatic recognition by powerful Arab countries and membership of Organization of Islamic Countries (OIC) in 1974

Why was this important?

- could make security/trade agreement
- no advancement as a nation

in the 7-day war between Palestine and Israel,

Bangladesh supported Palestine

- helped in getting recognition from muslim countries (OIC)
- travelling to Israel was once banned in our passport

## BANGLADESH AND THE WORLD



Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman addresses the Non-Aligned Movement (NAM) Summit Conference in Algiers (September 1973)



Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman embracing Anwar Sadat, the President of Egypt (1973)

direct result of Russia USA cold war

- First world country and third world country terms were not introduced on the basis of economic condition of a country as we know it now
- small countries are affected in many ways due to the Cold War due to smaller proxy wars or effects
- those countries formed a force:
  - ✓ we don't have enmity with neither USA nor Soviets
  - ✓ we won't be puppet of either of them
  - ✓ only diplomatic relation and trade allowed.

Hence we won't follow first world or second world, we are the third world.

USA/  
west

Russia

non-aligned

Done so to escape the geopolitical influence of the cold war

Road First

## MAKING OF THE CONSTITUTION

- One of the great achievements of the government in its first twelve months in power was the successful completion of the task of constitution-making
- On 23 March the Constitution Assembly Order was promulgated
- On 10 April the Constituent Assembly met for two days and created a thirty-four member special committee headed by the Law Minister

## MAKING OF THE CONSTITUTION

- The Constitution was drafted within six months
- The Constituent Assembly met on 12 October and it passed the constitution bill on 4 November
- The Constitution became effective on 16 December 1972 - exactly a year after the liberation of Bangladesh
- It encapsulated the four fundamental principles of the state: democracy, nationalism, secularism, and socialism

There exists two criticisms of the Constitution:

- it was drafted too fast - in 2 months
  - ↳ so its legitimacy was questioned
  - ↳ was people's opinions taken into account?
- it was said citizens of this country would be called Bengalis
  - ↳ not all people are Bengalis
  - ↳ ethnic minorities exist (Chakma, Marma, Santal)
  - ↳ Bihari's exist
    - ↳ region protested (freedom fighters)

We as a dominant race started undermining other races.

↳ unfortunate in Bangladesh's history

not prioritised  
we as a nation are racist

we looted their land in hill tracts

\* Position of Biharis in 1971:

- They helped a lot during the war
- Provided war shelter in their homes (Hindu women took shelter)
- some were freedom fighters
- we were rape and massacred them as well
- Bihari camps were attacked

- Every political party who came into power used the Constitution to solidify their power or rule, even though the Constitution was meant to be unchanged and absolute, but they brought about amendments.

③ The BD constitution had the president at the head who has a lot of power (can even appoint PM) but he cannot exercise it. But in BD, the party that wins names the PM from own members. A President can declare emergency when there's war or natural calamity only for 120 days (can be extended). An emergency is when the citizens' human rights are cancelled [police can keep you in jail for 6 months, you can't bail]. But in 2013, it was decided that the president can declare emergency ONLY if approved by parliament → why → 2006 crisis of khromata parliament and military coup.



- ↳ In Bangladesh, the Defense Head is President and the Defense Minister is the Prime Minister
- ↳ The President can appoint the Chief Justice and other judges but now, president has to consult the PM
- ↳ President can approve a mercy petition but only after consulting the PM.
- ↳ He can also appoint the VC of public and private university since he is the chancellor [although the uni sends 3 names to the Education Ministry which sends it to the President]
- ↳ The President can call the Parliament and dissolve it → after consulting the PM
- ↳ Constitution dictates "mahamanno rashtrapotir nirdeśhe, gonoshasther ardeśhe" but it's actually "rashtrapotir nirdeśhe and by PM or consultation e".
- ↳ President's speech in the Parliament must be Cabinet Approved
- ↳ President can approve any bill (law/budget) if he does not sign it within 7-15 days, the bill is automatically approved.
- ↳ The only right a President has is to resign office himself.

- ↳ The Presidential election is done by parliamentary PM
- ↳ Generally, the opposition party does not appoint anyone because that person will get no votes
- ↳ The Presidency can be impeached through Parliament majority vote
- ↳ During BNP's time, the President Badruzaa Choudhury did not give flowers on Zia r Mazar and so BNP claimed the president was not loyal and so he resigned before he got impeached. (formed a party against BNP with his son)
- ↳ The Parliament holds a total of 350 seats → 300 elected + 50 reserved for women
- ↳ The Head Speaker is in charge of conducting the Parliament and will be the Acting President if the President is dead / really sick / away for an extended period
- ↳ The Chief Whip + 5 Whips — decide the time allocation and sequence of MPs to speak. They also provided disciplinary action if any MP causes disruption in the Parliament.
- ↳ You cannot stay absent from the Parliament for more than 90 days (of running Parliament session) otherwise the membership is cancelled.
- ↳ If attended, you will receive honourum; if not, you'll get little less honourum.
- ↳ 10% technocrat ministers
  - of the total number of ministers
  - minister without being an MP
- ↳ PM's adviser → does not need to take an oath of secrecy.
  - no limitation of number of advisers
  - equivalent to minister
  - cannot attend cabinet meetings unless invited by PM

#### # Article 70: Floor Crossing

No MP from a particular party can vote against his party, otherwise their parliament membership is cancelled

- Not applicable for independent MPs
- If you leave your party, your parliament membership is also cancelled.



## AMENDMENTS TO THE CONSTITUTION

- The Constitution (Fourth Amendment) Act 1975 brought major changes into the constitution. The presidential form of government was introduced in place of the parliamentary system
- The Constitution (Fifth Amendment) Act, 1979 validated all amendments, additions, modifications, substitutions and omissions made in the constitution during the period between 15 August 1975 and 9 April 1979 by the Martial Law authorities

lots of controversies arose

due to this:

- ✓ one party government system
- ✓ one president alone
- ✓ soviet model
- but context was different

→ Bangla will get priority in case of crisis

personal notes: → If there's democracy in a country and you cannot take action to solve a matter politically, if you have to take matters to judges; then there's no democracy in that country

- ① added "Bismillah..." to the preamble
- ② removed secularism "স্বাধীনতা, সমতা, সত্য"
- ③ nationalism changed to Bengali nationalism

Ziaur Rahman

- ① legalized political injustices, gave "স্বাধীনতা" to all of Mujib's killers

→ invented word → they don't need trial

## AMENDMENTS TO THE CONSTITUTION

- The Constitution (Eighth Amendment) Act, 1988 declared, among others, that Islam shall be state religion and also decentralised the judiciary by setting up six permanent benches of the High Court Division outside Dhaka
- The Constitution (Thirteenth Amendment) Act, 1996 introduced a non-party Caretaker Government (CTG) system which, acting as an interim government, would give all possible aid and assistance to the Election Commission for holding the general election
- The Constitution (Fifteenth Amendment) Act 2011 restored secularism and freedom of religion, incorporating nationalism, socialism, democracy and secularism as the fundamental principles of the state policy

→ Military rule also brought: Army President  
outlet looks at changes to the Constitution

→ Ershad BGS said state religion shall be Islam

→ But he did not follow Shariah laws

→ Dhaka from Dacca

→ 6 benches of High Court to be held outside Dhaka. Judges will go there (still a violation of constitution)

→ BNP wanted to hold election

→ Awami League declined, instead protested for a Caretaker Government

→ movement so powerful and successful BNP allied Caretaker Government

→ election held under Caretaker Government

→ Awami League won

### 12th Amendment:

- Democracy starts as an official parliamentary form of government is formed

### Incumbent Gov.

The Party in power would be responsible for holding the elections

### Caretaker Gov.

→ Chief Advisor = Prime Minister = Last retired Chief Justice

→ 10 Advisors = Ministers

→ Must hold election within 90 days then leave

→ If retired Chief Justice dies or denies, ask two of his predecessors

If there is still no solution, President should sit with all political parties and ask them to select someone that everyone wants

→ If still no solution, then the President will become the Chief Minister

### 4th Amendment:

→ Mujib will be President

→ No more political parties; an one party system will be introduced

→ 3/4th MP vote will result in President impeachment

→ State controlled media → all but 4

→ One party will be called BAKSAL (Bangladesh Krishak Samik Awami League)

→ All abolished parties should join here now if they want to continue politics.

→ BAKSAL must be joined by all gov. and defence officers

### Reasons:

- Mujib was surrounded by corrupted people and a gap was created between him and his loyal people
- if BAKSAL had not been created, "grihojuddho" would've occurred.



# BANGLADESH ON THE EVE OF INDEPENDENCE

## Bangladesh on the Eve of Independence

- Bangladesh, devastated during 1971 genocide and war of liberation was described as a "basket case" by Henry Kissinger
- GDP of the first two years were negative.
  - ✓ -4.83% in 1971
  - ✓ -14.74% in 1972
- Poverty rate was 70%
- Economy was dependent on rain-fed agriculture
- Only 61% (by 1981 census) found work at market wages

## POVERTY TRENDS IN BANGLADESH 1990-2019

Bangladesh experienced impressive & steady poverty reduction from 49% in 2000 to 24.3% in 2017 and 21.8% in 2019

Extreme poverty declined from 34.3% in 2000 to 14.8% in 2017 and 9.2% in 2019

In parallel, life expectancy, literacy rates and per capita food production have increased significantly

## BANGLADESH ON THE EVE OF INDEPENDENCE

Other indicators:

- Population Growth Rate -2.6%
- Life Expectancy - 42 Years
- Infant mortality rate beyond the age of 5 - 239 out of 1000
- Literacy Rate - 24.3% (Female Literacy: 14.8%)
  - ✓ Primary Enrollment rate - 60% (Girl enrollment- 41%)
  - ✓ Secondary Enrollment - 18.1% (Girl enrollment- 7.9%)
- Rural and urban were isolated worlds, where urban areas consisted of 7.7% of the population

communication gap/delay

## DEVELOPMENT IN BANGLADESH

- Services and migration-linked remittances are contributing to GDP growth rates that are currently in excess of 6%
- The rural-urban divide has given way to a rural-urban continuum
- An extensive system of safety net programs has virtually eliminated post-disaster secondary cycles of death and hunger
- Known as a disaster-management role model on the global stage
- Average number of children born per women has come down from 6.9 to 2.1

## DEVELOPMENT IN BANGLADESH

After 48 years:

- Poverty reduced to 21.8%
- Food production tripled to 35 million MT  
BD self sufficient in food production with 2.6m MT surplus
- Population growth reduced to 1.1%
- Irrigation, mechanization and modern farming practices altered the agricultural landscape
- RMG turning into a \$32 billion export sector in 2018 from a late 70s base of a few million dollars

agricultural method updated

- we are not only dependent on nature now
- we are dependent on science and technology
- more efficient ways found

## CHANGES IN MORTALITY

Primary contributing factors to child surviving:

- vaccines, adequate nutrition and basic medical and maternal care

Other crucial contributing factors to child surviving:

- improvement in education, access to clean water and adequate sanitation, adequate food, child protection and women's empowerment

## DRIVERS OF POVERTY REDUCTION

Economic factors:

- The transition from a predominately agriculture based economy into a manufacture and service based economy
- The emergence and expansion of the RMG sector
- Occupational change within the labor force - movement from daily and self-employed work toward salaried jobs
- Growth in international remittance
- Productivity increases in agriculture

• Why did garments industry bloom here?

- ✓ cheap labour
- ✓ women labour cheapest (exploited)
- ✓ they are paid less than they work
- ✓ women are most affected



# WOMEN AS AGENTS OF CHANGE IN BANGLADESH

## Bangladesh Context

- **Legal Equality:**
  - Family laws (marriage, divorce, inheritance, custody) determined by religious personal laws (Islamic, Hindu, Anglican/ Catholic)—some reforms
  - Constitution guarantees equal rights in public sphere
- **Violence against women :**
  - about 49 per cent are/ever married women experienced spousal physical violence (NIRPORT, 2007)
  - Child marriage is high ; currently 53 (UNDP, 2018)
- **Women in Politics:**
  - parliament (20.3%); local government 25% reservation;
  - women PM, women speaker, women ministers
- **Labor force/ Work: 33 percent for women**
  - Urban areas:**
    - formal sectors mostly RMG-about 2 million; informal sectors (domestic workers)
    - government sector has quotas (15 per cent): primary education; health workers; nursing dominated by women
    - wage gap narrowing for middle class women in professional jobs (still persists)
  - Rural Areas:**
    - Agriculture (home-based)
    - public works for vulnerable women (divorced, abandoned etc)
    - microcredit- 20.6 million borrowers-majority women (World Bank, 2008); SME growing
- **Women's condition and status has changed**
- **Bangladesh's Gender Development Index (GDI) rank: 134 (UNDP, 2018)**
- **Faster improvement after starting from lower points compared to countries in South Asia post 1971**
- **Health and education improved- the pace of improvement**
  - **Maternal mortality:** more than halved from 648 (1986) to 315 (2001) (World Bank, 2008); fertility declines from 7.4 in 1970s to 2.7 (2007)
  - **Education:** literacy rate: 49.5 for adult women ; gender parity in primary and secondary education; higher secondary stipend —female enrollment increased

## How did this change?

- In 1973, the GOB had no information on women and the FFYP focuses on women's role as mothers/ rehab for rape survivors of war
- Now development planning and policy targets women as service users, economic agents, CSO actors, policy makers
- **Actors:**
  - Government through policies, actions (family planning / health; education);
  - NGOs: service delivery and rights (non formal education; credit; legal aid);
  - donor: funding creative initiatives (policy networks/ HR awareness raising, anti VAW; shelter; trafficking)
- **Mostly the women who did the heavy lifting!**

## Women as Agents of Change

- Women have a long history in participating in anti colonial struggles/social welfare/ economic entrepreneurship
  - Rokeya—educationist for Muslim women, feminist inspiration (late 1800s to 1930s)
  - Pritilata (1920/ 30s)/ Ila Mitra (1950s)/ Kumudini Hajong (1950s) fought colonial powers
  - Leela Nag (1920/30s)/ Shauhmunnahar Mahmud (1940/50s/60s)— social welfare/ disaster relief
  - Sufia Kamal- poet and established BMP, the largest women's organization with 150,000 members at the grassroots (1940s to 1990s)

## Development Challenges/ Wider Challenges for Women's Agency

- Accessing global policy spaces on trade/labor(RMG/ shrimps/ migration)—who speaks for women in spaces that are not gender friendly? What is happening post Rana plaza?
- Women's double burden the care economy work—recognizing that in policy
- VAW in public space—how to contain/ change values/ and implementation of domestic violence act, sexual harassment laws
- Climate change (work opportunities/ impact on reproductive burden/ time--water; natural disasters affecting families)
- Changing biased family laws
- Sticky norms and behaviour change
- COVID-19

ability to do and act  
ability to change

## Women's Agency (ability to do and act)

- Women credit borrowers— many of whom successful entrepreneurs in pulling their families out of poverty (joint decision making/ space)—handle cash, meet outside; repay back in time
- RMG worker— learned to negotiate at home (marriage /control over income/ etc; but also right to be in public spaces)— keep the industry running
- Women health worker— behind family planning's success
- Professional women (doctors/lawyers/academics)/ women in state service

## Issues Tackled by Women's Movement Over the years

- **1970s:** rehabilitation, development initiatives
- **1980s:** violence against women (dowry); family courts; political participation; gender mainstreaming; personal law; population policy; Islam as state religion
- **1990s:** fatwa (religious edict); state violence (custodial rape); uniform family code; mainstreaming gender/gender budgets; acid violence; shrimp farming; sexual harassment in educational institutions; CHT, minority rights; trafficking; sex worker's movements
- **2000 onward:** migration; minority rights; domestic violence; sexual harassment, national women's development policy



Known formerly as the Bangladesh Rehabilitation Assistance Committee, then as the Bangladesh Rural Advancement Committee, and later as Building Resources Across Communities,<sup>[11]</sup> BRAC was initiated in 1972 by Sir Fazlul Hasan Abed at Shallah Upazila in the district of Sunamganj as a small-scale relief and rehabilitation project to help returning war refugees after the Bangladesh Liberation War of 1971.

## BANGLADESH AT INDEPENDENCE

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- GDP of the first two years were negative.
  - ✓ -6.83% in 1971
  - ✓ -14.74% in 1972
- Poverty rate was 70%
- Economy was dependent on rain-fed agriculture
- Only 61% (by 1981 census) found work at market wages
- Per capita income in 1972 (US\$) - 129

## BANGLADESH AT INDEPENDENCE

- Other indicators:
- Population Growth Rate -2.6%
  - Life Expectancy - 46.5 Years
  - Infant mortality rate beyond the age of 5 - 239 out of 1000
  - Literacy Rate - 24.3% (Female Literacy- 14.8%)
    - ✓ Primary Enrollment rate - 60% (Girl enrollment- 41%)
    - ✓ Secondary Enrollment - 18.1% (Girl enrollment- 7.9%)
  - Rural and urban were isolated worlds, where urban areas consisted of 7.7% of the population
  - Population living in rural areas- 92.099%

## TREMENDOUS NATIONAL ENERGY IN REBUILDING BANGLADESH

Fazle Hasan Abed returns to Bangladesh January 1972

creates BRAC: January 1972

- conduct relief and rehabilitation in Sullas

starts long term Sullas (community) development: October 1972

- build community centers (gonokendras)
- provide adult literacy & occupational skills development programs
- form cooperative societies

Abed had previous experience in disaster relief creating HELP and providing relief in 1970 cyclone devastated Manpara

## BRAC'S UNDERSTANDING OF POWER STRUCTURES

BRAC's immersion in post-independence rural Bangladesh and first hand understanding of poverty and the poor led to major critical insights

Poverty was not a mere economic phenomenon, nor was it a "natural" condition; poverty was created, strengthened and reproduced through unequal structures of power

- unequal landownership and resources
- dominant kinship and factions
- linkages to political and bureaucratic elites
- control of capital markets (moneylending, usury, dadan)
- control of product markets (payment of low prices to producers)
- control of labor markets (low wages, advance sale of labor, extra economic coercion)
- patriarchal structures

BRAC recognized that creating economic opportunities need to go hand in hand with poor people organizing to confront such inequities

## SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT

- Eliminating extreme poverty
- Expanding financial choices
- Employable skills for decent work
- Climate change and emergencies
- Gender equality
- Universal access to healthcare
- Pro-poor urban development
- Investing in the next generation

## RURAL CREDIT AND TRAINING

RCTP: A Phased Development-Credit Program

- baseline surveys of villages to assess economic contexts
- selection of clients and projects for credit
- members from poor economic groups organize into "samities"
- members train in functional education (conscientization)
- members engage in savings programs
- members start group economic activities

1986: RCTP phased into the Rural Development Program

## SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT

### Eliminating extreme poverty

- Ultra-poor graduation
- Integrated development

### Expanding financial choices

- Microfinance

### Employable skills for decent work

- Skills development
- Migration

### Climate change and emergencies

- Climate change
- Disaster risk management

## SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT

### Gender equality

- Gender justice and diversity
- Social empowerment and legal protection
- Strengthening Bangladesh's RMG sector

### Universal access to healthcare

- Health, nutrition and population
- Water, sanitation and hygiene

### Pro-poor urban development

- Urban development

### Investing in the next generation

- Education
- Youth platform

## BRAC EXPANSION TO JAMALPUR AND MANIKGANGA

**Jamalpur: June 1975**  
exclusively for a small number of FFW recipient women

- literacy training
- health hygiene and family planning
- joint savings
- cooperative economic activities in poultry and horticulture
- self confidence and self esteem
- staffing from local 8th grade educated women

## LESSON FROM SULLA

- Need for self-reflection and transparency
- Build staff competency
- management
- adult education
- health paramedics
- Focus on savings
- Develop income generating activities
- Target women
- Move from handouts to cost-recovery
- Reduce donor dependence through internal resource mobilization
- long term sustainability critical for development



BEST OF  
LUCK!!!

May the odds be ever in your favor!